

The Founder's Field Guide to *Government Schemes*

Every central and state scheme that can put money, tax relief, customers or lab space behind an Indian startup – with who qualifies, what to file, and how to apply.

115

SCHEMES

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CENTRAL

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OPEN OR
RECURRING

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STUDENT-FRIENDLY

An independent guide, not an official government publication. Compiled from ministry and state portals, PIB releases, Parliament replies and news coverage, checked in September 2026. Confirm current terms on the official portal before applying.

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HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

Reading an entry

Central schemes are grouped by what they give you; state schemes follow, A–Z by state. Every entry lists the maximum support, who runs it, who can apply, the steps and the documents.

Most state schemes stack on top of central ones.

OPEN • ROLLING

Accepting applications now, any time.

CLOSES ON A DATE

A live call with a fixed deadline.

CLOSED

Not accepting applications; kept for reference in case it reopens.

OPENS IN ROUNDS

Runs calls or cohorts; watch the portal for the next window.

ANNOUNCED

Approved or budgeted, but guidelines or portal not yet live.

EFFORT

Our estimate: simple online form, proposal and review, or competitive pitch/jury.

Scope: schemes open to any founder, plus schemes for students. Schemes reserved for specific founder groups are not covered in this edition. Amounts are maximums; actual support depends on your project and the agency's appraisal.

A beginner's roadmap

Each step unlocks the next: recognition opens tax and credit benefits, incubation opens grants, and a working product opens seed money and debt.

For founders

01 INCORPORATE THE COMPANY

Register a private limited company or LLP through the MCA portal. Most schemes need an incorporated entity.

02 GET DPIIT RECOGNITION AND UDYAM REGISTRATION

Both are free and online. DPIIT unlocks central startup benefits; Udyam unlocks MSME loans, guarantees and procurement preferences.

→ [DPIIT](#) · [Udyam](#)

03 REGISTER WITH YOUR STATE'S STARTUP PORTAL

State allowances, seed grants and reimbursements need state registration. Open the map to find yours.

04 JOIN AN INCUBATOR

Incubators are the doorway to PRAYAS, EIR, NIDHI-SSP, TIDE and many state grants.

→ [Incubators](#)

05 PROTECT YOUR IP CHEAPLY

File patents and trademarks as a recognised startup to get the fee rebates.

→ [SIPP](#)

06 FUND THE PROTOTYPE WITH GRANTS

Idea-stage grants don't dilute you. Pick those that match your sector.

→ [PRAYAS](#) · [TIDE 2.0](#) · [BIG](#) · [RKVY](#)

07 TAKE THE PRODUCT TO MARKET

Seed grants, accelerators and challenges for startups with a working product.

→ [NIDHI-SSP](#) · [SAMRIDH](#) · [ANIC](#) · [iDEX](#)

08 ADD DEBT WITHOUT COLLATERAL

Guaranteed loans let you borrow for working capital and equipment without pledging assets.

→ [CGSS](#) · [CGTMSE](#) · [Mudra](#)

09 RAISE EQUITY

Pitch VC funds backed by the government's Fund of Funds, or sector funds for space and agri.

→ [FoF 2.0](#) · [AgriSURE](#) · [Space VC Fund](#)

10 SELL TO GOVERNMENT AND CLAIM THE TAX HOLIDAY

Use procurement relaxations on GeM, and apply for the IMB certificate once you're profitable.

→ [GeM](#) · [Sec 140](#)

For students

01 START WITH YOUR CAMPUS

Join your college's innovation cell and ask about startup credits, leave and IP policy.

→ [IIC](#) / [NISIP](#)

02 COMPETE

Hackathons and challenges build a team, a prototype and credibility.

→ [SIH](#) · [BioE3 Challenge](#) · [Dare to Dream](#)

03 GET A STIPEND TO GO FULL TIME

Fellowships pay you to work on your idea instead of taking a job.

→ [NIDHI-EIR](#) · [TIDE 2.0](#)

04 BUILD THE PROTOTYPE WITH A GRANT

No company needed at this stage for most of these.

→ [PRAYAS](#) · [SITARE](#) · [MSME Innovative](#)

05 USE YOUR STATE'S STUDENT SCHEME

Several states fund student prototypes directly.

→ [SSIP 2.0](#) · [NAIN](#) · [IEDC](#) · [AP Policy 4.0](#) · [Delhi Policy](#)

06 INCORPORATE AND GET RECOGNISED

When you're ready for customers or investors, form a company and get DPIIT recognition.

→ [DPIIT](#) · [SIPP](#)

The last twelve months

New schemes, closures and changed limits from 2025–26 that affect startups.

SEP 2026	Semicon 2.0 revamps chip-design support MeitY notified new DLI terms: VC co-investment, royalty financing and a 9% deployment incentive (up to ₹30 crore).
JUL 2026	Delhi approves ₹400 crore Start-up Policy 2026 Runs through universities, colleges, polytechnics and ITIs; targets 10,000 startups.
JUN 2026	Punjab raises seed grant to ₹5 lakh Up from ₹3 lakh under the Punjab Startup & Industrial Policy 2026.
MAY 2026	Startup India Seed Fund closes SISFS stopped taking startup applications after two extensions; no successor announced yet.
MAY 2026	First RDI Fund cheques released Five deep-tech startups funded through TDB and BIRAC, including ₹105 crore to a space startup.
APR 2026	Fund of Funds 2.0 guidelines issued ₹10,000 crore for deep tech, micro-VC, manufacturing and sector-agnostic funds; SIDBI implements.
APR 2026	80-IAC becomes Section 140 The Income-tax Act, 2025 took effect; the startup tax holiday continues under a new section number.
MAR 2026	Mutual credit guarantee eased for manufacturers MCGS-MSME now covers 75% for exporters and needs equipment to be only 60% of project cost.
FEB 2026	Railways launches Rail Tech Policy iDEX-style portal; up to 50% funding and bigger prototype and scale-up grants.
FEB 2026	New DPIIT startup definition Turnover limit doubled to ₹200 crore; new Deep Tech Startup category (20 years, ₹300 crore); co-ops eligible.
FEB 2026	Budget 2026-27 for small firms ₹10,000 crore SME Growth Fund, ₹2,000 crore SRI Fund top-up, Biopharma SHAKTI, TReDS push and Corporate Mitras.
JAN 2026	Karnataka Startup Policy 2025-30 launched ₹675 crore outlay; ELEVATE NxT deep-tech grants up to ₹1 crore.

JAN 2026

5th States' Startup Ranking released

Gujarat best among large states; Arunachal Pradesh and Goa best among small states and UTs.

OCT 2025

PRIP opens for pharma and medtech

Startups can get up to ₹5 crore for early-stage projects.

SEP 2025

Goa rolls out Startup Policy 2025

Adds a Campus Innovation Scheme for students.

AUG 2025

Maharashtra approves 2025 startup policy

₹500 crore Maha-Fund and ₹25 lakh pilot orders via Startup Week.

MAY 2025

CGSS cover doubled to ₹20 crore

Lower 1% fee for startups in 27 champion sectors.

All 115 schemes

SCHEME	WHERE	TYPE	SUPPORT	STATUS
CENTRAL • REGISTRATION, TAX & COMPLIANCE				
DPIIT Startup Recognition ·S	All India	Registration & compliance	Free • gateway to most benefits	Open • rolling
Udyam (MSME) Registration	All India	Registration & compliance	Free • unlocks MSME benefits	Open • rolling
Startup Tax Holiday (Section 140, formerly 80-IAC)	All India	Tax relief	100% profit deduction for 3 years	Open • rolling
Angel Tax Abolished	All India	Tax relief	No tax on share premium	Automatic
Other Startup Tax Reliefs (ESOP deferral, loss carry-forward)	All India	Tax relief	Deferred ESOP tax; losses carried forward	Automatic
Self-Certification under Labour & Environment Laws	All India	Registration & compliance	Fewer inspections for 3-5 years	Open • rolling
Fast-Track Exit for Startups (IBC)	All India	Registration & compliance	Wind up within ~90 days	Open • rolling
Corporate Mitras (compliance help)	All India	Mentoring & network	Affordable compliance support	Announced — not yet open
CENTRAL • IP, SELLING TO GOVERNMENT & GETTING PAID				
Startup IP Protection (SIPP): patent & trademark fee rebates ·S	All India	IP support	80% off patent fees, 50% off trademark fees	Open • rolling
Selling to Government: GeM Startup Runway & procurement relaxations	All India	Govt buyer	Waived turnover, experience and EMD rules	Open • rolling
TReDS Invoice Discounting	All India	Loan	Get paid on invoices in days	Open • rolling
ZED Certification Subsidy	All India	Subsidy	Up to 80% of certification cost	Open • rolling
CENTRAL • INCUBATION, MENTORING & LEARNING				
Get Incubated: TBIs, Atal Incubation Centres & BioNEST ·S	All India	Incubation	Subsidised space, labs and mentoring	Open • rolling
Startup India Hub, Investor Connect & MAARG Mentoring ·S	All India	Mentoring & network	Free	Open • rolling
Startup India Learning Programme ·S	All India	Mentoring & network	Free online course + certificate	Open • rolling
Institution's Innovation Council & National Innovation and Startup Policy ·S	All India	Incubation, Mentoring & network	Campus support: credits, IP help, startup leave	Open • rolling
Atal Tinkering Labs (schools) ·S	All India	Labs & infra	Maker labs in schools (₹20 lakh per school)	Open • rolling
Chips to Startup (C2S) Programme ·S	All India	Mentoring & network, Stipend	Chip-design training, EDA tools, project funding via institutes	Opens in rounds

SCHEME	WHERE	TYPE	SUPPORT	STATUS
Technology Innovation Hubs (NM-ICPS) ·S	All India	Grant, Stipend	Startup grants and fellowships, by hub call	Opens in rounds
National Startup Awards	All India	Challenge / prize	Cash prize + national recognition	Opens in rounds
CENTRAL · GRANTS, FELLOWSHIPS & ACCELERATORS (ANY SECTOR)				
NIDHI-PRAYAS (prototype grant) ·S	All India	Grant	Up to ₹10 lakh	Opens in rounds
NIDHI-Entrepreneur in Residence (EIR) ·S	All India	Stipend	₹10,000-₹30,000 a month for up to 12 months	Opens in rounds
NIDHI Seed Support Programme	All India	Grant, Equity	Up to ₹1 crore	Opens in rounds
MeitY TIDE 2.0 ·S	All India	Grant, Stipend	EIR up to ₹4 L; grant up to ₹7 L	Opens in rounds
MeitY SAMRIDH Accelerator	All India	Equity, Incubation	Up to ₹40 lakh	Opens in rounds
MeitY GENESIS (tier-2/3 startups) ·S	All India	Grant, Equity	From ₹10 lakh to ₹1 crore by track	Opens in rounds
Atal New India Challenge (ANIC 2.0)	All India	Grant, Challenge / prize	Up to ₹1 crore	Opens in rounds
MSME Innovative Scheme (Incubation, IPR, Design) ·S	All India	Grant, IP support	Up to ₹15 L per idea; IPR up to ₹5 L	Open · rolling
INSPIRE-MANAK Awards (school students) ·S	All India	Grant, Challenge / prize	₹10,000 per selected idea	Opens in rounds
Smart India Hackathon 2026 ·S	All India	Challenge / prize	Cash prizes + incubation offers	Opens in rounds
Startup India Seed Fund Scheme	All India	Grant, Loan	Up to ₹20 L grant + ₹50 L debt	Closed
CENTRAL · LOANS & CREDIT GUARANTEES				
Credit Guarantee Scheme for Startups	All India	Credit guarantee, Loan	Collateral-free loans up to ₹20 cr	Open · rolling
CGTMSE Collateral-Free MSME Loans	All India	Credit guarantee, Loan	Collateral-free loans up to ₹10 cr	Open · rolling
PM Mudra Yojana (incl. Tarun Plus) ·S	All India	Loan	Collateral-free loans ₹50,000-₹20 lakh	Open · rolling
Prime Minister's Employment Generation Programme ·S	All India	Subsidy, Loan	15-35% subsidy on projects up to ₹50 L	Open · rolling
Mutual Credit Guarantee Scheme for MSMEs	All India	Credit guarantee, Loan	60% guarantee on equipment loans up to ₹100 cr	Open · rolling
SIDBI SMILE Soft Loans	All India	Loan	Soft-term loans from ₹10 lakh	Open · rolling
CENTRAL · EQUITY & FUNDS				
Startup India Fund of Funds 2.0	All India	Equity	₹10,000 cr corpus via VC funds	Open · rolling

SCHEME	WHERE	TYPE	SUPPORT	STATUS
Self-Reliant India (SRI) Fund	All India	Equity	₹50,000 cr fund-of-funds; ₹2,000 cr top-up in 2026	Open · rolling
SME Growth Fund	All India	Equity	₹10,000 cr	Announced — not yet open
CENTRAL · DEEP TECH, AI, SEMICONDUCTORS & TELECOM				
Research, Development & Innovation (RDI) Fund	All India	Loan, Equity	Up to 50% of project cost; loans at 3-4%	Open · rolling
Technology Development Board Assistance	All India	Loan, Equity	Soft loans / equity up to 50% of project cost	Open · rolling
IndiaAI Compute (subsidised GPUs) ·S	All India	Compute, Subsidy	38,000+ GPUs at subsidised hourly rates	Open · rolling
Semicon 2.0 — Design Linked Incentive (DLI)	All India	Grant, Equity	Was 50% up to ₹15 cr; revamped Sep 2026	Open · rolling
Telecom Technology Development Fund	All India	Grant	R&D grants by call (₹542 cr approved across 136 projects)	Opens in rounds
CENTRAL · BIOTECH, HEALTH & PHARMA				
BIRAC Biotechnology Ignition Grant ·S	All India	Grant	Up to ₹50 lakh	Opens in rounds
BIRAC SEED Fund	All India	Equity	Up to ₹30 lakh equity	Opens in rounds
BIRAC LEAP Fund	All India	Equity	Up to ₹100 lakh equity	Opens in rounds
BIRAC SBIRI & BIPP (industry R&D)	All India	Grant, Loan	Grants + soft loans, sized by project	Opens in rounds
BIRAC student programmes (SITARE-GYTI, E-YUVA) ·S	All India	Grant, Stipend	Up to ₹15 lakh (GYTI awards)	Opens in rounds
D.E.S.I.G.N. for BioE3 Challenge ·S	All India	Challenge / prize, Grant	₹1 lakh–₹25 lakh	Opens in rounds
PRIP — Research & Innovation in Pharma-MedTech	All India	Grant	Up to ₹5 cr for startups	Open · rolling
Biopharma SHAKTI	All India	Grant, Equity	₹10,000 cr over 5 years	Announced — not yet open
CENTRAL · AGRICULTURE & FOOD				
RKVY Agri-Startup Programme (formerly RKVY-RAFTAAR) ·S	All India	Grant, Incubation	₹5 L (idea) + ₹25 L (seed)	Opens in rounds
AgriSURE Fund	All India	Equity	Tickets up to ~₹25 cr	Open · rolling
Agriculture Infrastructure Fund	All India	Loan, Subsidy	Loans up to ₹2 cr with 3% interest subvention	Open · rolling
PM Formalisation of Micro Food Processing Enterprises	All India	Subsidy, Loan	35% subsidy, up to ₹10 lakh	Closes 30 Sep 2026
CENTRAL · DEFENCE, SPACE, RAILWAYS & TEXTILES				
iDEX Defence Startup Challenges (DISC & Open Challenge)	All India	Grant, Challenge / prize	Up to ₹1.5 crore	Closes 30 Sep 2026

SCHEME	WHERE	TYPE	SUPPORT	STATUS
IDEX ADITI (deep-tech defence)	All India	Grant	Up to ₹25 crore (50% of product budget)	Opens in rounds
DRDO Technology Development Fund	All India	Grant	Up to ₹50 crore per project	Open · rolling
DRDO Dare to Dream Innovation Contest ·S	All India	Challenge / prize	Prizes up to ₹10 lakh	Opens in rounds
IN-SPACe Seed Fund Scheme	All India	Grant	Seed support for space startups (₹65 cr envelope)	Open · rolling
IN-SPACe Technology Adoption Fund	All India	Grant	₹500 cr fund; up to ₹25 cr per project	Open · rolling
Space Sector Venture Capital Fund	All India	Equity	₹1,000 cr fund	Open · rolling
Rail Tech Policy (Startups for Railways)	All India	Grant, Govt buyer	Up to 50% of project cost + order pipeline	Open · rolling
GREAT — Technical Textiles Startups ·S	All India	Grant	Up to ₹50 lakh	Opens in rounds
STATE & UT SCHEMES				
Andaman & Nicobar Startup Scheme	Andaman & Nicobar Islands	Mentoring & network, Challenge / prize	Pro-bono services for pitch winners	Open · rolling
AP Innovation & Startup Policy 4.0 (2024-29) ·S	Andhra Pradesh	Grant, Equity	₹2 L prototype · ₹15–20 L scale-up · up to ₹2 cr seed	Open · rolling
Ratan Tata Innovation Hub ·S	Andhra Pradesh	Incubation	Free plug-and-play space + programmes	Open · rolling
Arunachal Pradesh State Startup Policy	Arunachal Pradesh	Grant, IP support	₹5 L support grant · PoC ₹10 L · scale-up to ₹25 L	Opens in rounds
Assam Start-up & Innovation Policy 2025	Assam	Grant, Stipend	₹10 L idea → ₹25 L pilot → ₹50 L scale-up	Open · rolling
Bihar Startup Policy 2022 ·S	Bihar	Loan, Grant	₹10 L interest-free for 10 years + ₹3 L matching	Open · rolling
Chandigarh Startup Policy 2025 ·S	Chandigarh	Grant, Challenge / prize	₹7 L seed · ₹12 L early-growth	Announced — not yet open
Chhattisgarh Innovation & Startup Promotion Policy 2025-30 ·S	Chhattisgarh	Grant, Loan	₹100 cr capital fund; seed, interest subsidy, risk-free loans	Open · rolling
DNH & DD Investment Promotion Scheme 2022-27 (startups)	Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu	Subsidy, IP support	15% capital subsidy up to ₹15–35 L	Open · rolling
Delhi Start-up Policy 2026 ·S	Delhi	Grant, Incubation	₹400 cr over 5 years	Announced — not yet open
Goa Startup Policy 2025 ·S	Goa	Grant, Subsidy	Seed up to ₹10 L + cost reimbursements	Open · rolling
Gujarat Scheme for Assistance to Startups & Innovation ·S	Gujarat	Grant, Stipend	Up to ₹30 L seed + ₹20–25k/month	Opens in rounds

SCHEME	WHERE	TYPE	SUPPORT	STATUS
Student Startup & Innovation Policy (SSIP 2.0) ·S	Gujarat	Grant, IP support	Up to ₹2.5 L per prototype + IPR costs	Opens in rounds
Haryana State Startup Policy 2022	Haryana	Grant, Subsidy	Seed ₹10 L · patents up to ₹25 L	Open · rolling
Himachal CM Startup / Innovation Projects Scheme ·S	Himachal Pradesh	Stipend, Incubation	₹25,000 a month for a year	Open · rolling
J&K Start-up Policy 2024-27 ·S	Jammu & Kashmir	Grant, Equity	Seed grants up to ₹20 L · ₹250 cr VC fund	Open · rolling
Jharkhand Startup Policy 2023	Jharkhand	Stipend, Grant	₹5,000/month per founder (up to 3)	Open · rolling
Karnataka Startup Policy 2025-30 ·S	Karnataka	Grant, Equity	₹675 cr outlay	Open · rolling
ELEVATE (Idea2PoC) Grant	Karnataka	Grant, Challenge / prize	Up to ₹50 lakh	Opens in rounds
ELEVATE NxT (deep tech)	Karnataka	Grant	Up to ₹1 crore	Opens in rounds
Beyond Bengaluru Cluster Seed Fund	Karnataka	Equity	₹75 cr fund; ~₹50 L per startup	Open · rolling
NAIN — New Age Incubation Network (colleges) ·S	Karnataka	Grant, Incubation	Around ₹4–5 lakh per student project	Opens in rounds
KSUM Innovation Grants (Idea, Productisation, Scale-up) ·S	Kerala	Grant	₹3 L idea · ₹7 L product · ₹15 L scale-up	Open · rolling
KSUM Seed Fund (soft loan)	Kerala	Loan	Up to ₹15 lakh at 6%	Open · rolling
KSUM IEDC Student Innovation Grants ·S	Kerala	Grant, Incubation	Up to ₹2 lakh per student idea	Open · rolling
Ladakh Startup Incentives	Ladakh	Stipend, Grant	₹15k/month + ₹3 L MVP + ₹3 L marketing	Open · rolling
MP Startup Policy & Implementation Scheme 2025	Madhya Pradesh	Grant, Equity	Seed up to ₹30 L; 15% of funds raised (up to ₹60 L)	Open · rolling
Maharashtra Startup, Entrepreneurship & Innovation Policy 2025 ·S	Maharashtra	Grant, IP support	₹500 cr Maha-Fund; ₹25 L pilot orders	Open · rolling
Maharashtra Startup Week	Maharashtra	Govt buyer, Challenge / prize	Work orders up to ₹25 lakh	Opens in rounds
Maha-Fund for early entrepreneurs ·S	Maharashtra	Grant, Incubation	₹500 cr corpus	Open · rolling
Start-Up Manipur	Manipur	Grant, Subsidy	₹3 L idea · up to ₹30 L revenue stage	Closed
PRIME Meghalaya Funding	Meghalaya	Grant, Loan	Grants to ₹35 L · 0% loans to ₹75 L	Opens in rounds
Mizoram Startup Mission & Bana Kaih	Mizoram	Grant, Loan	Grants, venture funding, credit linkage	Open · rolling
Nagaland Startup Policy 2019	Nagaland	Subsidy, IP support	Reimbursements up to ₹5–10 L each	Open · rolling
Startup Odisha Incentives	Odisha	Stipend, Grant	₹20k/month + up to ₹15 L product & marketing	Open · rolling

SCHEME	WHERE	TYPE	SUPPORT	STATUS
Puducherry Startup Policy 2019	Puducherry	Grant, Stipend	₹3 L grant + ₹10k/month per person	Open · rolling
Punjab Startup & Industrial Policy 2026	Punjab	Grant	Seed grant ₹5 lakh	Open · rolling
iStart Rajasthan ·S	Rajasthan	Grant, Stipend	Seed up to ₹10 L; ₹10–25k/month allowance	Open · rolling
Sikkim Skilled Youth Startup Scheme ·S	Sikkim	Subsidy, Loan	25–35% subsidy on projects up to ₹20 L	Open · rolling
TANSEED	Tamil Nadu	Equity, Incubation	₹10 L (₹15 L for green, rural, women-led)	Opens in rounds
Tamil Nadu Startup & Innovation Policy (StartupTN) ·S	Tamil Nadu	Incubation, Equity	Seed, investor matching, regional hubs	Open · rolling
Innovation Voucher Programme (EDII-TN)	Tamil Nadu	Grant	₹3 L (Voucher A) · ₹7 L (Voucher B)	Closed
Telangana Startup Incentives (Innovation Policy)	Telangana	Subsidy, Tax relief	SGST refunds, patent costs, hiring support	Open · rolling
T-Hub, T-Works & T-Fund ·S	Telangana	Incubation, Equity	Incubation, prototyping labs, early equity	Open · rolling
Telangana Innovation Cell student & grassroots programmes ·S	Telangana	Challenge / prize, Grant	Recognition, seed & prototype support	Opens in rounds
Tripura Start-Up Policy 2024	Tripura	Grant, Stipend	₹2 L seed + ₹20k/month + ₹10 L prototype	Open · rolling
UP Startup Policy 2020 (amended 2022) ·S	Uttar Pradesh	Grant, Stipend	₹17,500/month + ₹5 L prototype + ₹7.5 L seed	Open · rolling
Uttarakhand Startup Policy 2023	Uttarakhand	Stipend, Grant	₹20k/month + ₹5 L product & marketing	Open · rolling
Startup Bengal & new state startup policy ·S	West Bengal	Grant, Equity	₹40 cr incubation fund · ₹60 cr VC fund (announced)	Announced — not yet open

·S = student-friendly.

Registration, tax & compliance

The paperwork that unlocks everything else, and the tax and compliance relief that comes with it.

CENTRAL · DPIIT, MINISTRY OF COMMERCE & INDUSTRY

OPEN · ROLLING

DPIIT Startup Recognition

SUPPORT	Free · gateway to most benefits	TYPE	Registration & compliance
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Simple — online form	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

The official 'startup' tag Most central benefits – tax holiday, CGSS, fund-of-funds money, IPR rebates and procurement relaxations – only unlock once you hold this certificate. The February 2026 framework doubled the turnover limit and created a new Deep Tech Startup category.

WHAT YOU GET

- Unlocks Section 140 tax holiday, CGSS, FoF 2.0-backed AIFs, SIPP fee rebates and GeM relaxations
- Turnover limit raised from ₹100 crore to ₹200 crore (G.S.R. 108(E), 4 Feb 2026)
- New Deep Tech Startup category: recognition for up to 20 years and ₹300 crore turnover
- Cooperative societies can now be recognised, alongside companies, LLPs and partnership firms

WHO CAN APPLY

- Private limited company, LLP, registered partnership firm or cooperative society
- Up to 10 years from incorporation (20 years for deep tech startups)
- Annual turnover below ₹200 crore in every year since incorporation (₹300 crore for deep tech)
- Working on innovation or improvement of a product, process or service, or a scalable business model

HOW TO APPLY

1. Create an account on the Startup India portal (or the National Single Window System)
2. Fill in the recognition form: entity details, sector, and a short note on what is innovative
3. Upload the incorporation certificate and a pitch deck or website link
4. Submit; recognition is usually issued within a few working days, with a certificate number you will quote everywhere else

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Company PAN and GST registration (if registered)
- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction
- ☐ Patent or IP filings, or a prior-art search (if any)

Official: www.startupindia.gov.in/content/sih/en/startupgov/startup_recognition_page.html Stacks with: Sec 140, CGSS, SIPP, GeM

Checked: Verified Sep 2026 against the 4 Feb 2026 notification coverage

Udyam (MSME) Registration

SUPPORT	Free · unlocks MSME benefits	TYPE	Registration & compliance
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Simple — online form	DPIIT NEEDED	No

The free, paperless MSME registration using your Aadhaar and PAN. You need it for CGTMSE, PMEGP-linked support, MSME procurement preferences, delayed-payment protection and TReDS.

WHAT YOU GET

- Access to MSME credit guarantees, subsidies and public procurement preferences
- Protection against delayed payments (buyers must pay within 45 days)

WHO CAN APPLY

- Any micro, small or medium enterprise

HOW TO APPLY

1. Go to the Udyam portal and enter the proprietor's/director's Aadhaar
2. Fill in PAN and business details; the certificate is issued online

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN
- ☐ Company PAN and GST registration (if registered)

Official: udyamregistration.gov.in

Stacks with: CGTMSE, TReDS, GeM

Checked: Standing

Startup Tax Holiday (Section 140, formerly 80-IAC)

SUPPORT	100% profit deduction for 3 years	TYPE	Tax relief
STAGE	Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	Yes

Eligible startups pay no income tax on profits for any 3 consecutive years out of their first 10. Since 1 April 2026 the benefit sits in Section 140 of the Income-tax Act, 2025 (it was Section 80-IAC under the 1961 Act).

WHAT YOU GET

- 100% deduction of profits for 3 consecutive years of your choosing within the first 10
- Available to startups incorporated up to 31 March 2030
- Applications are reviewed within about 120 days under the revised process

WHO CAN APPLY

- DPIIT-recognised private limited company or LLP
- Incorporated between 1 April 2016 and 31 March 2030
- Needs a separate Inter-Ministerial Board (IMB) certificate — DPIIT recognition alone is not enough
- Turnover cap per the Income-tax Act, 2025 conditions (confirm the current limit with your CA)

HOW TO APPLY

1. Log in to the Startup India portal and open the 80-IAC / Section 140 application form
2. Explain the innovation, revenue model and employment impact; attach financials
3. The IMB reviews the application and may ask for clarifications
4. Once certified, claim the deduction in your company's income-tax return for the years you choose

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ DPIIT recognition certificate
- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Financial statements / ITRs for the last 2–3 years (if any)
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction

- ☐ Patent or IP filings, or a prior-art search (if any)
- ☐ Board resolution authorising the application

Official: www.startupindia.gov.in/content/sih/en/form80iac.html Stacks with: DPIIT, No angel tax

Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (PIB, May 2025; Income-tax Act 2025 renumbering)

CENTRAL · MINISTRY OF FINANCE

AUTOMATIC

Angel Tax Abolished

SUPPORT	No tax on share premium	TYPE	Tax relief
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Nothing to apply for	DPIIT NEEDED	No

The old 'angel tax' – tax on share premium above fair value under Section 56(2)(viib) – was repealed from assessment year 2025-26 and was not carried into the Income-tax Act, 2025. Raising equity at a premium no longer triggers this tax for any company.

WHAT YOU GET

- No tax on funds raised above fair market value from resident or foreign investors
- Removes the need for DPIIT angel-tax exemption filings (Form 2)

WHO CAN APPLY

- Applies automatically to all closely held companies
- Other anti-abuse rules (unexplained credits, below-market transfers) still apply – keep investor KYC and valuation reports

HOW TO APPLY

1. Nothing to apply for – keep a valuation report and investor KYC on file for each round
2. Report the allotment in your MCA filings as usual

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Cap table / shareholding pattern
- ☐ Board resolution authorising the application

Official: www.incometaxindia.gov.in Stacks with: FoF 2.0, Sec 140 Checked: Verified Sep 2026

CENTRAL · MINISTRY OF FINANCE & DPIIT

AUTOMATIC

Other Startup Tax Reliefs (ESOP deferral, loss carry-forward)

SUPPORT	Deferred ESOP tax; losses carried forward	TYPE	Tax relief
STAGE	Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Nothing to apply for	DPIIT NEEDED	Yes

Employees of eligible startups can defer tax on ESOPs until they sell shares, leave, or five years pass. Eligible startups can also carry forward losses despite ownership changes, as long as the original shareholders continue.

WHAT YOU GET

- ESOP perquisite tax deferred – employees don't pay tax on paper gains at exercise
- Business losses carried forward even when shareholding changes, subject to conditions

WHO CAN APPLY

- DPIIT-recognised startups holding the IMB tax certificate (for ESOP deferral)

HOW TO APPLY

1. Obtain the IMB certificate (see the Section 140 entry)
2. Have your CA apply the deferral in TDS on ESOPs and the carry-forward in your return

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ DPIIT recognition certificate
- ☐ Cap table / shareholding pattern
- ☐ Board resolution authorising the application

- Original shareholders must continue to hold shares for the loss carry-forward relief

Official: www.incometaxindia.gov.in/income-from-business/profession-taxation-of-start-ups Stacks with: Sec 140

Checked: Summary of standing provisions; confirm section numbers under the 2025 Act with your CA

CENTRAL • DPIIT, MINISTRY OF LABOUR, MOEFCC

OPEN • ROLLING

Self-Certification under Labour & Environment Laws

SUPPORT	Fewer inspections for 3-5 years	TYPE	Registration & compliance
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Simple — online form	DPIIT NEEDED	Yes

Recognised startups can self-certify compliance with key labour and environment laws, so routine inspections are skipped in the early years unless there's a credible complaint.

WHAT YOU GET

- Self-certification under labour laws for up to 5 years
- Startups in 'white category' industries are exempt from certain environment inspections

WHO CAN APPLY

- DPIIT-recognised startup

HOW TO APPLY

1. Submit the self-declaration on the Shram Suvidha / state labour portal
2. Keep your registers and records updated in case of a complaint-triggered inspection

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ DPIIT recognition certificate

Official: www.startupindia.gov.in

Stacks with: DPIIT

Checked: Standing provision

CENTRAL • MINISTRY OF CORPORATE AFFAIRS / IBBI

OPEN • ROLLING

Fast-Track Exit for Startups (IBC)

SUPPORT	Wind up within ~90 days	TYPE	Registration & compliance
STAGE	Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Startups with simple debt structures can be wound up on a fast track, so failed ventures don't trap founders in years of proceedings.

WHAT YOU GET

- Insolvency resolution on a fast track for eligible startups
- Frees founders to start again quickly

WHO CAN APPLY

- Startups meeting the fast-track criteria under the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (simple debt structure, specified turnover limits)

HOW TO APPLY

1. Consult an insolvency professional to check fast-track eligibility
2. File with the adjudicating authority as advised

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Financial statements / ITRs for the last 2–3 years (if any)
- ☐ Board resolution authorising the application

Official: ibbi.gov.in

Checked: Standing provision

Corporate Mitras (compliance help)

SUPPORT	Affordable compliance support	TYPE	Mentoring & network
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Simple — online form	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Announced in Budget 2026-27

A Budget 2026-27 plan to train a cadre of para-professionals, especially in tier-2 and tier-3 towns, who help small firms with compliance at low cost.

WHAT YOU GET

- Low-cost help with filings and compliance

HOW TO APPLY

1. Watch for rollout via ICAI, ICSI and ICMAI

WHO CAN APPLY

- Small businesses and startups (details awaited)

Official: www.indiabudget.gov.in Stacks with: Udyam Checked: Announced; not yet rolled out

IP, selling to government & getting paid

Cheaper patents, relaxed tender rules and faster payment on invoices.

CENTRAL · DPIIT & OFFICE OF CGPDTM (IP INDIA)

OPEN · ROLLING

Startup IP Protection (SIPP): patent & trademark fee rebates

SUPPORT	80% off patent fees, 50% off trademark fees	TYPE	IP support
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Simple — online form	DPIIT NEEDED	Yes · Student-friendly

Recognised startups file patents at a fraction of the normal cost, get free help from empanelled facilitators, and can ask for expedited examination — often cutting grant time from years to months.

WHAT YOU GET

- 80% rebate on patent filing fees and 50% on trademark fees
- Government-paid patent and trademark facilitators — you pay only statutory fees
- Expedited patent examination on request

WHO CAN APPLY

- DPIIT-recognised startup (students' patents can use the startup's recognition once incorporated)

HOW TO APPLY

1. Pick a facilitator from the IP India list of empanelled patent/trademark agents
2. File with IP India selecting the 'startup' applicant category and attach your DPIIT certificate
3. Request expedited examination (Form 18A) if you need a faster grant

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ DPIIT recognition certificate
- ☐ Patent or IP filings, or a prior-art search (if any)
- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN

Official: ipindia.gov.in

Stacks with: DPIIT, MSME Innovative

Checked: Standing scheme; verified active Sep 2026

CENTRAL · DPIIT, DEPT OF EXPENDITURE & GEM

OPEN · ROLLING

Selling to Government: GeM Startup Runway & procurement relaxations

SUPPORT	Waived turnover, experience and EMD rules	TYPE	Govt buyer
STAGE	Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Simple — online form	DPIIT NEEDED	Yes

Central ministries and PSUs can buy from recognised startups without asking for prior turnover or experience, and startups are exempt from earnest money deposits. GeM's Startup Runway lets you list innovative products that don't yet fit standard catalogue categories.

WHAT YOU GET

- Exemption from prior turnover and prior experience criteria in public tenders (quality and technical specs still apply)
- Exemption from Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)
- List new-to-market products on GeM via Startup Runway

HOW TO APPLY

1. Register as a seller on GeM using your DPIIT certificate
2. Tag your listings as startup products or apply through Startup Runway for novel items
3. Quote the startup exemption clause when bidding for tenders

WHO CAN APPLY

- DPIIT-recognised startup
- Product or service must meet the tender's technical specifications

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ DPIIT recognition certificate
- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Company PAN and GST registration (if registered)
- ☐ Udyam (MSME) registration certificate

Official: gem.gov.in

Stacks with: DPIIT, Udyam, TReDS

Checked: Standing policy; verified Sep 2026

CENTRAL • RBI-LICENSED PLATFORMS (POLICY BY MINISTRY OF FINANCE & MSME)

OPEN • ROLLING

TReDS Invoice Discounting

SUPPORT	Get paid on invoices in days	TYPE	Loan
STAGE	Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Simple — online form	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Sell your invoices on large buyers — companies, PSUs, government — to financiers on a TReDS platform and get cash in days instead of waiting 60–90 days. Budget 2026-27 made TReDS mandatory for central PSU purchases from small firms and added a CGTMSE guarantee.

WHAT YOU GET

- Fast, collateral-free working capital against invoices
- Budget 2026: TReDS mandatory for CPSE purchases; linked with GeM

WHO CAN APPLY

- Udyam-registered MSMEs selling to buyers registered on TReDS

HOW TO APPLY

1. Register on a TReDS platform (RXIL, M1xchange, Invoicemart and others)
2. Upload invoices accepted by your buyer; financiers bid

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Udyam (MSME) registration certificate
- ☐ Company PAN and GST registration (if registered)
- ☐ Bank statements for the last 6–12 months

Official: www.rbi.org.in

Stacks with: Udyam, GeM, CGTMSE

Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (Budget 2026-27)

CENTRAL • MINISTRY OF MSME

OPEN • ROLLING

ZED Certification Subsidy

SUPPORT	Up to 80% of certification cost	TYPE	Subsidy
STAGE	Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Manufacturing & hardware
EFFORT	Simple — online form	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Zero Defect Zero Effect certification signals quality to buyers. The government pays most of the certification cost (80% for micro, 60% for small, 50% for medium enterprises).

WHAT YOU GET

- 80/60/50% subsidy on certification cost
- Bronze level certification is fully subsidised after taking the ZED pledge

WHO CAN APPLY

- Udyam-registered manufacturing MSMEs

HOW TO APPLY

1. Take the ZED pledge on the ZED portal
2. Apply for Bronze, Silver or Gold certification

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Udyam (MSME) registration certificate

Official: zed.msme.gov.in

Stacks with: Udyam, GeM

Checked: Standing scheme

Incubation, mentoring & learning

Where to get space, labs, mentors – and the doorway to most grants.

CENTRAL · DST, AIM (NITI AAYOG), BIRAC, MEITY

OPEN · ROLLING

Get Incubated: TBIs, Atal Incubation Centres & BioNEST

SUPPORT	Subsidised space, labs and mentoring	TYPE	Incubation
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

Hundreds of government-backed incubators – DST's TBIs, Atal Incubation Centres, Atal Community Innovation Centres in tier-2/3 towns, BIRAC BioNEST, MeitY TIDE centres – offer cheap desks, labs and mentors. Being incubated is the entry ticket to PRAYAS, EIR, SSP, TIDE and many state grants.

WHAT YOU GET

- Low-cost desks, labs and prototyping facilities
- Mentors, investor days and help with scheme applications

WHO CAN APPLY

- Founders or students with an idea; selection by each incubator

HOW TO APPLY

1. Shortlist incubators strong in your sector (search the Startup India incubator list)
2. Apply to their cohort call
3. Sign the incubation agreement

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction
- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN
- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget

Official: www.startupindia.gov.in

Stacks with: PRAYAS, NIDHI-EIR, NIDHI-SSP, TIDE 2.0

Checked: Standing network

CENTRAL · DPIIT / INVEST INDIA

OPEN · ROLLING

Startup India Hub, Investor Connect & MAARG Mentoring

SUPPORT	Free	TYPE	Mentoring & network
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Simple — online form	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

Free national platforms: a single portal for queries and scheme applications, an investor-matching platform run with SIDBI, and the MAARG portal to book mentors by sector.

WHAT YOU GET

- Investor Connect: match with VCs and angels
- MAARG: sector mentors for early-stage founders
- Help desk and challenge listings from ministries and corporates

WHO CAN APPLY

- Open to all founders; some features need DPIIT recognition

HOW TO APPLY

1. Create a free Startup India profile
2. Complete your startup profile to appear in Investor Connect
3. Book mentors through MAARG

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction

CENTRAL · DPIIT / INVEST INDIA

OPEN · ROLLING

Startup India Learning Programme

SUPPORT	Free online course + certificate	TYPE	Mentoring & network
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Simple — online form	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

A free, self-paced online course taught by successful Indian founders covering ideation, fundraising, legal basics and go-to-market. A good first step for students.

WHAT YOU GET

- Free lessons from founders and investors
- Certificate on completion

HOW TO APPLY

1. Sign up on the Startup India portal
2. Complete the modules at your own pace

WHO CAN APPLY

- Anyone — no incorporation needed

CENTRAL · MINISTRY OF EDUCATION INNOVATION CELL & AICTE

OPEN · ROLLING

Institution's Innovation Council & National Innovation and Startup Policy

SUPPORT	Campus support: credits, IP help, startup leave	TYPE	Incubation, Mentoring & network
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Simple — online form	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

Colleges with an IIC run bootcamps and pre-incubation. Under the National Innovation and Startup Policy, institutes can give academic credit for startup work, allow a semester or year off to run a startup, and help students file IP.

WHAT YOU GET

- Academic credit and flexible attendance for startup work
- Startup leave (a semester or year) with option to return
- Pre-incubation, IP filing help and mentoring on campus

HOW TO APPLY

1. Contact your college's IIC or innovation cell
2. Ask what your institute's startup policy allows (credits, leave, IP share)

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Student ID or bonafide certificate from your institution

WHO CAN APPLY

- Students of institutions that have an IIC and have adopted the policy

Atal Tinkering Labs (schools)

SUPPORT	Maker labs in schools (₹20 lakh per school)	TYPE	Labs & infra
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Simple — online form	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

Maker labs with 3D printers, electronics and robotics kits in schools across India, where students in Classes 6–12 can build projects and enter the ATL Marathon.

WHAT YOU GET

- Free access to a maker lab at your school
- ATL Marathon: top student innovations get incubation support

WHO CAN APPLY

- Students of schools with an ATL

HOW TO APPLY

1. Ask your school's ATL in-charge to join
2. Enter the annual ATL Marathon with your team's project

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Student ID or bonafide certificate from your institution

Official: aim.gov.in Stacks with: MANAK, SIH Checked: AIM 2.0 approved to Mar 2028

Chips to Startup (C2S) Programme

SUPPORT	Chip-design training, EDA tools, project funding via institutes	TYPE	Mentoring & network, Stipend
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue	SECTOR	Deep tech
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

Trains engineering students in chip design through participating academic institutions, with access to EDA tools and funding for design projects — a pipeline into semiconductor startups.

WHAT YOU GET

- Access to industry EDA tools and fabrication runs via your institute
- Project-based learning in VLSI and system design

WHO CAN APPLY

- Students and faculty at participating academic and R&D institutions

HOW TO APPLY

1. Check whether your college is a C2S participating institute
2. Join its chip-design project team or course

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Student ID or bonafide certificate from your institution

Official: www.meity.gov.in Stacks with: DLI, PRAYAS Checked: Standing programme

Technology Innovation Hubs (NM-ICPS)

SUPPORT	Startup grants and fellowships, by hub call	TYPE	Grant, Stipend, Incubation
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Deep tech, Software & AI
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

Twenty-five technology hubs hosted at IITs and other premier institutes each run startup grants, fellowships and challenges in their domain – AI, robotics, data, IoT, quantum and more.

WHAT YOU GET

- Seed grants and pre-incubation for deep-tech startups
- Student and research fellowships in the hub's domain

WHO CAN APPLY

- Varies by hub and call; many are open to students

HOW TO APPLY

1. Find the hub for your domain and follow its calls
2. Apply with a project proposal

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget
- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN
- ☐ Student ID or bonafide certificate from your institution

Official: dst.gov.in Stacks with: PRAYAS, NIDHI-EIR Checked: Standing programme

National Startup Awards

SUPPORT	Cash prize + national recognition	TYPE	Challenge / prize
STAGE	Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Competitive — pitch or jury	DPIIT NEEDED	Yes

5th edition results announced 12 Mar 2026; watch for the next call

Annual awards recognising outstanding startups and ecosystem enablers across sectors. Winners get prize money (₹10 lakh in recent editions), investor and government introductions, and pilot opportunities.

WHAT YOU GET

- Prize money for winners (₹10 lakh in recent editions)
- Visibility with ministries, corporates and investors

WHO CAN APPLY

- DPIIT-recognised startup meeting the edition's age and revenue criteria

HOW TO APPLY

1. Apply on the Startup India portal when the edition opens
2. Shortlisted startups present to a jury

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ DPIIT recognition certificate
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction
- ☐ Financial statements / ITRs for the last 2–3 years (if any)

Official: www.startupindia.gov.in/content/sih/en/nsa2025.html Stacks with: Startup India Hub

Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (5th edition results, Mar 2026)

Grants, fellowships & accelerators (any sector)

Non-dilutive money from idea to first market.

CENTRAL · DST – NIDHI PROGRAMME (VIA PRAYAS CENTRES AT TBIS)

[OPENS IN ROUNDS](#)

NIDHI-PRAYAS (prototype grant)

SUPPORT	Up to ₹10 lakh	TYPE	Grant
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue	SECTOR	Any sector, Deep tech, Manufacturing & hardware
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

The go-to grant for turning an idea into a working prototype — especially hardware. Individuals and students can apply before incorporating a company.

WHAT YOU GET

- Up to ₹10 lakh to build a prototype or proof of concept
- Mentoring, lab and fabrication access at the host incubator

WHO CAN APPLY

- Students, researchers, innovators or early startups with a technology idea
- You don't need to be incorporated
- Apply to one PRAYAS centre at a time

HOW TO APPLY

1. Find a PRAYAS centre near you on the NIDHI-PRAYAS portal
2. Apply during its call with a proposal and budget
3. Pitch to the centre's committee; funds are released in milestones

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN
- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget
- ☐ Student ID or bonafide certificate from your institution
- ☐ Educational certificates of the founders

Official: nidhi-prayas.org

Stacks with: NIDHI-EIR, NIDHI-SSP, SIPP

Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (nidhi.dst.gov.in)

CENTRAL · DST – NIDHI PROGRAMME (VIA EIR CENTRES AT TBIS)

[OPENS IN ROUNDS](#)

NIDHI-Entrepreneur in Residence (EIR)

SUPPORT	₹10,000–₹30,000 a month for up to 12 months	TYPE	Stipend
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

A monthly stipend so graduates can work full-time on a tech startup idea instead of taking a job, while sitting inside an incubator.

WHAT YOU GET

- Stipend of ₹10,000–₹30,000 per month
- Up to 12 months
- Co-working space and mentoring

WHO CAN APPLY

- Graduates and final-year students pursuing a technology-based idea

HOW TO APPLY

1. Apply to a NIDHI-EIR centre (list on the NIDHI-EIR site)
2. Interview and pitch; selected fellows sign on with the incubator

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN
- ☐ Educational certificates of the founders

- Should not hold another fellowship or full-time job at the same time
- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget

Official: www.nidhi-eir.in Stacks with: PRAYAS, NIDHI-SSP Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (nidhi.dst.gov.in)

CENTRAL • DST — NIDHI PROGRAMME (VIA TBIS)

[OPENS IN ROUNDS](#)

NIDHI Seed Support Programme

SUPPORT	Up to ₹1 crore	TYPE	Grant, Equity, Loan
STAGE	Early revenue	SECTOR	Any sector, Deep tech
EFFORT	Competitive — pitch or jury	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Seed money from DST-supported incubators for startups with a validated technology heading to market. The incubator decides the instrument (grant, debt, equity-linked).

WHAT YOU GET

- Up to ₹1 crore per startup
- Delivered by the incubator with mentoring

WHO CAN APPLY

- Startup incubated (usually 3+ months) at a participating TBI
- Innovative technology with a clear path to market

HOW TO APPLY

1. Get incubated at a DST-supported TBI
2. Apply when your incubator announces an SSP call
3. Present to the seed committee; sign the investment or grant agreement

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction
- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget
- ☐ Letter from your incubator confirming incubation
- ☐ Cap table / shareholding pattern
- ☐ Proof of prototype or PoC — photos, video, test data

Official: nidhi.dst.gov.in/nidhissp Stacks with: PRAYAS, NIDHI-EIR, Incubators Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (nidhi.dst.gov.in)

CENTRAL • MEITY (VIA TIDE 2.0 INCUBATORS)

[OPENS IN ROUNDS](#)

MeitY TIDE 2.0

SUPPORT	EIR up to ₹4 L; grant up to ₹7 L	TYPE	Grant, Stipend, Incubation
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Software & AI
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No • Student-friendly

Early-stage support for tech startups using AI, IoT, blockchain and other ICT in areas like health, education, agriculture and fintech, through a national network of TIDE 2.0 incubators.

WHAT YOU GET

- Entrepreneur-in-Residence support up to ₹4 lakh for idea/PoC stage
- Grant up to ₹7 lakh for prototype stage
- 12 months of pre-incubation

WHO CAN APPLY

- Indian citizens with an idea or PoC (EIR) or a working prototype (grant)
- Company registration needed for the grant track

HOW TO APPLY

1. Pick a TIDE 2.0 incubator (IITs, IIITs, universities) and apply to its call
2. Pitch and selection; funds released in tranches

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN
- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction

☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)

Official: msh.meity.gov.in/schemes/tide

Stacks with: SAMRIDH, GENESIS, Incubators

Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (IIT Hyderabad TIDE page)

CENTRAL · MEITY STARTUP HUB (VIA SELECTED ACCELERATORS)

OPENS IN ROUNDS

MeitY SAMRIDH Accelerator

SUPPORT	Up to ₹40 lakh	TYPE	Equity, Incubation
STAGE	Early revenue	SECTOR	Software & AI
EFFORT	Competitive — pitch or jury	DPIIT NEEDED	Yes

MeitY's accelerator programme for software product startups: up to ₹40 lakh matched with investment by the accelerator, plus customer connects and investor readiness.

WHAT YOU GET

- Up to ₹40 lakh, matched by the accelerator's own investment
- Structured acceleration, customer and investor access

WHO CAN APPLY

- DPIIT-recognised software/IT product startup with an MVP or early traction
- Selected through a SAMRIDH-partner accelerator

HOW TO APPLY

1. Watch MeitY Startup Hub for SAMRIDH accelerator cohorts
2. Apply to a partner accelerator
3. Selection, then matched investment

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ DPIIT recognition certificate
- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction
- ☐ Cap table / shareholding pattern
- ☐ Financial statements / ITRs for the last 2–3 years (if any)

Official: msh.meity.gov.in/schemes/samridh

Stacks with: TIDE 2.0, GENESIS, IndiaAI Compute

Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (secondary sources)

CENTRAL · MEITY STARTUP HUB

OPENS IN ROUNDS

MeitY GENESIS (tier-2/3 startups)

SUPPORT	From ₹10 lakh to ₹1 crore by track	TYPE	Grant, Equity
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Software & AI, Deep tech
EFFORT	Competitive — pitch or jury	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

Gen-Next Support for Innovative Startups: discovers and funds tech startups in tier-2 and tier-3 cities, with tracks from idea stage to pilots with a purchase order and deep tech.

WHAT YOU GET

- EIR-style support for individual innovators (around ₹10 lakh)
- Pilot support up to ₹40 lakh for startups with a purchase order
- Deep-tech track up to ₹1 crore

HOW TO APPLY

1. Apply via GENESIS partner incubators or the MSH portal when calls open

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction
- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget

WHO CAN APPLY

- Tech startups and innovators based outside the big metros
- Track-specific criteria (e.g., a valid PO for pilots)

Official: msh.meity.gov.in/schemes/genesis Stacks with: TIDE 2.0, SAMRIDH

Checked: Amounts per secondary sources; confirm on the current call

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)

CENTRAL · ATAL INNOVATION MISSION, NITI AAYOG

OPENS IN ROUNDS

Atal New India Challenge (ANIC 2.0)

SUPPORT	Up to ₹1 crore	TYPE	Grant, Challenge / prize
STAGE	Early revenue	SECTOR	Any sector, Agri & food, Energy & climate, Biotech, health & pharma, Space
EFFORT	Competitive — pitch or jury	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Grants for startups with a working prototype that solves a listed national challenge — in health, water, agriculture, food processing, housing, energy, mobility or space — to take it to market over 12–18 months.

WHAT YOU GET

- Up to ₹1 crore grant
- Mentoring and access to AIM's ecosystem partners

WHO CAN APPLY

- Indian startups/MSMEs with a prototype addressing a published challenge statement

HOW TO APPLY

1. Read the sector challenges on the AIM site
2. Apply in the open ANIC round
3. Screening, jury pitch, then milestone-based grants

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget
- ☐ Proof of prototype or PoC — photos, video, test data
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction
- ☐ Financial statements / ITRs for the last 2–3 years (if any)

Official: aim.gov.in/atal-new-india-challenge-2.0.php Stacks with: Incubators, PRAYAS

Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (aim.gov.in); AIM extended to Mar 2028

CENTRAL · MINISTRY OF MSME (VIA HOST INSTITUTES)

OPEN · ROLLING

MSME Innovative Scheme (Incubation, IPR, Design)

SUPPORT	Up to ₹15 L per idea; IPR up to ₹5 L	TYPE	Grant, IP support
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Any sector, Manufacturing & hardware
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

Three tools in one: grants to develop ideas at host institutes (incubation), reimbursement of IP registration costs, and co-funding of professional product design — all run through the MSME Champions portal.

WHAT YOU GET

- Incubation: up to ₹15 lakh per idea via a host institute

HOW TO APPLY

1. Register on the MSME Innovative module of the Champions portal
2. For incubation, submit your idea to a host institute

- IPR: reimbursement up to ₹5 lakh (foreign patent), ₹1 lakh (domestic patent), smaller amounts for trademarks and designs
- Design: co-funding of design projects with NID, IITs and other design institutes

WHO CAN APPLY

- Innovators and students (incubation, via host institutes)
- Udyam-registered MSMEs (IPR and design components)

Official: innovative.msme.gov.in

Stacks with: SIPP, Udyam, PMEGP

3. For IPR, file first and then claim reimbursement with fee receipts

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget
- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN
- ☐ Udyam (MSME) registration certificate
- ☐ Patent or IP filings, or a prior-art search (if any)
- ☐ Invoices and payment receipts for costs you're claiming

Checked: Guidelines on the MSME portal; amounts per 2022 guidelines

CENTRAL · DST & NATIONAL INNOVATION FOUNDATION

OPENS IN ROUNDS

INSPIRE-MANAK Awards (school students)

SUPPORT	₹10,000 per selected idea	TYPE	Grant, Challenge / prize
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Simple — online form	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

For school students aged 10–15 (Classes 6–10): schools nominate ideas, and selected students get ₹10,000 to build a model, with a chance to reach the national exhibition.

WHAT YOU GET

- ₹10,000 into the student's account for a model
- District, state and national exhibitions and mentoring

WHO CAN APPLY

- School students in Classes 6–10, nominated by their school

HOW TO APPLY

1. Your school registers on the E-MIAS portal and nominates ideas
2. Selected students receive the award and build a prototype

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Student ID or bonafide certificate from your institution

Official: www.inspireawards-dst.gov.in

Stacks with: ATL

Checked: Standing programme

CENTRAL · MINISTRY OF EDUCATION INNOVATION CELL & AICTE

OPENS IN ROUNDS

Smart India Hackathon 2026

SUPPORT	Cash prizes + incubation offers	TYPE	Challenge / prize
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

Internal hackathons Sep 2026; grand finale Dec 2026

The national hackathon where student teams solve real problem statements from ministries and industry. Winning teams get prize money and many go on to incubation.

WHAT YOU GET

- Prize money per problem statement for winners
- Visibility with ministries and incubation opportunities

WHO CAN APPLY

- Teams of 6 students from the same college, with at least one woman member

HOW TO APPLY

1. Ask your college SPOC to register the institute
2. Win the internal hackathon
3. Submit your idea for online screening (Oct–Nov); finalists compete in December

- Selected through your institute's internal hackathon

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Student ID or bonafide certificate from your institution

Official: sih.gov.in Stacks with: IIC / NISP, PRAYAS, NIDHI-EIR Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (timeline)

CENTRAL • DPIIT (VIA SELECTED INCUBATORS)

CLOSED

Startup India Seed Fund Scheme

SUPPORT	Up to ₹20 L grant + ₹50 L debt	TYPE	Grant, Loan
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	Yes

Closed to startups on 31 May 2026; no successor announced yet

India's flagship seed scheme: up to ₹20 lakh as a grant for proof of concept and prototypes, plus up to ₹50 lakh as debt or convertible instruments for market entry, disbursed through selected incubators. The ₹945 crore corpus has been allocated and applications closed in 2026.

WHAT YOU GET

- Up to ₹20 lakh grant for PoC, prototype and product trials
- Up to ₹50 lakh via convertible debentures or debt for market entry and scaling

WHO CAN APPLY

- DPIIT-recognised startup incorporated not more than 2 years before applying
- Must not have received more than ₹10 lakh from other central/state schemes

HOW TO APPLY

1. Watch the Startup India portal for a new scheme cycle
2. Meanwhile, use NIDHI-SSP, SAMRIDH and state seed grants, which are still open

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ DPIIT recognition certificate
- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction
- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget
- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN
- ☐ Cap table / shareholding pattern

Official: seedfund.startupindia.gov.in Checked: Verified Sep 2026: deadline was extended to 31 May 2026, then closed

Loans & credit guarantees

Collateral-free borrowing for working capital and equipment.

CENTRAL · DPIIT & NCGTC

OPEN · ROLLING

Credit Guarantee Scheme for Startups

SUPPORT	Collateral-free loans up to ₹20 cr	TYPE	Credit guarantee, Loan
STAGE	Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	Yes

The government guarantees most of a lender's risk, so banks, NBFCs and venture-debt funds can lend to startups without collateral. The cover limit was doubled to ₹20 crore per borrower in May 2025.

WHAT YOU GET

- Guarantee up to ₹20 crore per borrower (was ₹10 crore)
- 85% of default covered on loans up to ₹10 crore; 75% above that
- Annual guarantee fee cut to 1% for startups in 27 Make in India champion sectors
- Covers term loans, working capital and venture debt

WHO CAN APPLY

- DPIIT-recognised startup
- Not in default to any lender
- Loan from a scheduled bank, NBFC, all-India financial institution or SEBI-registered AIF

HOW TO APPLY

1. Approach your bank, NBFC or venture-debt fund and ask for a CGSS-covered loan
2. The lender appraises you and applies to NCGTC for the guarantee
3. Pay the annual guarantee fee (usually passed on by the lender)

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ DPIIT recognition certificate
- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Financial statements / ITRs for the last 2–3 years (if any)
- ☐ Bank statements for the last 6–12 months
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction
- ☐ Cap table / shareholding pattern

Official: www.startupindia.gov.in/content/sih/en/credit-guarantee-scheme-for-startups.html Stacks with: DPIIT, FoF 2.0, TReDS

Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (PIB, 9 May 2025)

CGTMSE Collateral-Free MSME Loans

SUPPORT	Collateral-free loans up to ₹10 cr	TYPE	Credit guarantee, Loan
STAGE	Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Simple — online form	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Banks lend to micro and small enterprises without collateral or third-party guarantees because CGTMSE covers most of the risk. The limit rose to ₹10 crore from April 2025.

WHAT YOU GET

- Guarantee on loans up to ₹10 crore without collateral
- Covers term loans and working capital

WHO CAN APPLY

- New or existing micro and small enterprises (manufacturing or services) with Udyam registration
- Loan from a member lending institution

HOW TO APPLY

1. Approach any bank or NBFC that is a CGTMSE member lending institution
2. Ask for the loan to be covered under CGTMSE
3. The lender pays the guarantee fee (usually recovered from you)

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Udyam (MSME) registration certificate
- ☐ Detailed project report (DPR) with cost estimates
- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN
- ☐ Bank statements for the last 6–12 months
- ☐ Financial statements / ITRs for the last 2–3 years (if any)

Official: www.cgtmse.in Stacks with: Udyam, PMEGP, Mudra Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (scheme document as of 1 Apr 2025)

PM Mudra Yojana (incl. Tarun Plus)

SUPPORT	Collateral-free loans ₹50,000–₹20 lakh	TYPE	Loan
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Simple — online form	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

Small collateral-free business loans in four tiers: Shishu (up to ₹50,000), Kishore (up to ₹5 lakh), Tarun (up to ₹10 lakh) and Tarun Plus (₹10–20 lakh) for those who have repaid a Tarun loan.

WHAT YOU GET

- No collateral required
- Tarun Plus up to ₹20 lakh for good repayers

WHO CAN APPLY

- Non-farm income-generating micro enterprises: manufacturing, trading, services and allied agriculture

HOW TO APPLY

1. Apply at any bank branch, NBFC or MFI, or on the Udyamimitra portal
2. Loan sanctioned after appraisal

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN
- ☐ Detailed project report (DPR) with cost estimates
- ☐ Bank statements for the last 6–12 months
- ☐ Quotations for machinery or equipment

Official: www.mudra.org.in Stacks with: PMEGP, CGTMSE Checked: Verified Sep 2026

Prime Minister's Employment Generation Programme

SUPPORT	15–35% subsidy on projects up to ₹50 L	TYPE	Subsidy, Loan
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue	SECTOR	Any sector, Manufacturing & hardware
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

A capital subsidy on bank loans for new micro enterprises: up to ₹50 lakh project cost for manufacturing and ₹20 lakh for services, with 15–35% of the cost given as margin money subsidy.

WHAT YOU GET

- Subsidy of 15% (urban) or 25% (rural) for general category; 25–35% for special categories
- Second loan for upgrading successful units: up to ₹1 crore (manufacturing) with 15–20% subsidy

WHO CAN APPLY

- Individuals aged 18+; Class 8 pass for projects above ₹10 lakh (manufacturing) / ₹5 lakh (services)
- New units only; one person per family

HOW TO APPLY

1. Apply online on the PMEGP e-portal
2. KVIC/DIC task force interview; bank sanctions the loan
3. Complete the entrepreneurship training; subsidy is adjusted after 3 years

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Detailed project report (DPR) with cost estimates
- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN
- ☐ Educational certificates of the founders
- ☐ Bank statements for the last 6–12 months
- ☐ Quotations for machinery or equipment

Official: www.kviconline.gov.in/pmegportal

Stacks with: CGTMSE, Udyam, Mudra

Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (current parameters)

Mutual Credit Guarantee Scheme for MSMEs

SUPPORT	60% guarantee on equipment loans up to ₹100 cr	TYPE	Credit guarantee, Loan
STAGE	Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Manufacturing & hardware
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Modified 21 Mar 2026 (exporters: 75% cover)

For manufacturing MSMEs buying plant and machinery: a 60% government guarantee on loans up to ₹100 crore, making big equipment purchases bankable. Exporters get 75% cover.

WHAT YOU GET

- 60% guarantee on loans up to ₹100 crore; 75% for eligible exporters (up to ₹20 crore)
- Equipment need be only 60% of project cost (was 75%)

WHO CAN APPLY

- Udyam-registered MSMEs; exporters need 25%+ export share for 3 years

HOW TO APPLY

1. Apply through your lender, which seeks NCGTC cover

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Udyam (MSME) registration certificate
- ☐ Detailed project report (DPR) with cost estimates
- ☐ Financial statements / ITRs for the last 2–3 years (if any)
- ☐ Quotations for machinery or equipment

Official: www.ncgtc.in

Stacks with: CGTMSE, Udyam

Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (PIB, 21 Mar 2026)

SIDBI SMILE Soft Loans

SUPPORT	Soft-term loans from ₹10 lakh	TYPE	Loan
STAGE	Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Manufacturing & hardware
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No

The Make in India Soft Loan Fund for MSMEs: quasi-equity style soft loans to help manufacturing and service MSMEs meet debt-equity requirements for expansion.

WHAT YOU GET

- Soft loans on relaxed terms to support the promoter's contribution

WHO CAN APPLY

- MSMEs in manufacturing and services, especially Make in India sectors

HOW TO APPLY

1. Apply to SIDBI directly or through its online portal

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Udyam (MSME) registration certificate
- ☐ Financial statements / ITRs for the last 2–3 years (if any)
- ☐ Detailed project report (DPR) with cost estimates

Official: www.sidbi.in Stacks with: CGTMSE, MCGS-MSME Checked: Listed open Sep 2026

Equity & funds

Government money that flows to startups through venture and growth funds.

CENTRAL • DPIIT (SIDBI AS IMPLEMENTING AGENCY)

OPEN • ROLLING

Startup India Fund of Funds 2.0

SUPPORT	₹10,000 cr corpus via VC funds	TYPE	Equity
STAGE	Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Any sector, Deep tech, Manufacturing & hardware
EFFORT	Competitive — pitch or jury	DPIIT NEEDED	Yes

The government doesn't invest in startups directly; it commits capital to SEBI-registered venture funds (AIFs), which then invest in DPIIT-recognised startups. Version 2.0 (approved 14 Feb 2026; guidelines 25 Apr 2026) earmarks money for deep tech, micro-VC funds for early-growth startups, and tech-led manufacturing

WHAT YOU GET

- More VC money for deep tech, manufacturing and early-growth startups beyond the metros
- Four fund segments: deep tech, micro VC, innovative manufacturing, and sector-agnostic
- FoF 1.0 backed 145 AIFs that invested ₹25,500+ crore in 1,370+ startups

WHO CAN APPLY

- DPIIT-recognised startup raising equity from an AIF that has FoF commitment
- The AIF — not you — applies to SIDBI; you pitch the AIF like any other investor

HOW TO APPLY

1. Find AIFs backed by the Fund of Funds (SIDBI publishes the list)
2. Pitch those funds directly; mention your DPIIT recognition
3. Close the round on normal VC terms

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ DPIIT recognition certificate
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction
- ☐ Cap table / shareholding pattern
- ☐ Financial statements / ITRs for the last 2–3 years (if any)

Official: sidbivcf.in/en

Stacks with: CGSS, Sec 140, No angel tax

Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (PIB, 14 Feb & 25 Apr 2026)

CENTRAL • MINISTRY OF MSME (NSIC VENTURE CAPITAL FUND)

OPEN • ROLLING

Self-Reliant India (SRI) Fund

SUPPORT	₹50,000 cr fund-of-funds; ₹2,000 cr top-up in 2026	TYPE	Equity
STAGE	Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Any sector, Manufacturing & hardware
EFFORT	Competitive — pitch or jury	DPIIT NEEDED	No

A mother fund that invests in daughter funds, which provide equity to MSMEs with growth potential. Budget 2026-27 added ₹2,000 crore to keep risk capital flowing to micro enterprises.

WHAT YOU GET

- Growth equity for MSMEs via SEBI-registered daughter funds

WHO CAN APPLY

- Udyam-registered MSMEs with scalable businesses

HOW TO APPLY

1. Pitch daughter funds empanelled under the SRI Fund

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Udyam (MSME) registration certificate
- ☐ Financial statements / ITRs for the last 2–3 years (if any)

- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction
- ☐ Cap table / shareholding pattern

Official: msme.gov.in Stacks with: SME Growth Fund, CGTMSE Checked: Top-up verified (PIB, Budget 2026-27)

CENTRAL · MINISTRY OF FINANCE / MSME

ANNOUNCED — NOT YET OPEN

SME Growth Fund

SUPPORT	₹10,000 cr	TYPE	Equity
STAGE	Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Any sector, Manufacturing & hardware
EFFORT	Competitive — pitch or jury	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Announced in Budget 2026-27; operating guidelines awaited

A ₹10,000 crore fund announced in Budget 2026-27 to create 'future champions' by giving equity and quasi-equity to high-performing SMEs selected on set criteria.

WHAT YOU GET

- Equity/quasi-equity for fast-growing SMEs

WHO CAN APPLY

- Criteria to be notified

HOW TO APPLY

1. Watch the MSME Ministry for guidelines

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Udyam (MSME) registration certificate
- ☐ Financial statements / ITRs for the last 2–3 years (if any)

Official: msme.gov.in Stacks with: SRI Fund Checked: Verified Sep 2026: not yet operational

Deep tech, AI, semiconductors & telecom

Long-horizon R&D capital and infrastructure.

CENTRAL · ANRF / DST (VIA TDB AND BIRAC AS FUND MANAGERS)

OPEN · ROLLING

Research, Development & Innovation (RDI) Fund

SUPPORT	Up to 50% of project cost; loans at 3–4%	TYPE	Loan, Equity
STAGE	Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Deep tech, Biotech, health & pharma, Energy & climate, Software & AI, Agri & food
EFFORT	Competitive — pitch or jury	DPIIT NEEDED	No

A ₹1 lakh crore, six-year fund for private R&D in strategic and sunrise sectors. Startups at technology readiness level (TRL) 4 and above get long-term, low-cost loans or equity through second-level fund managers — TDB for most sectors, BIRAC for biotech. The first cheques went out in May 2026.

WHAT YOU GET

- Long-term loans at 3–4% interest, repayable over 12–15 years with a moratorium
- Equity up to 25% of assistance, or soft loans convertible to equity
- Covers up to 50% of assessed project cost (relaxable in strategic sectors)

WHO CAN APPLY

- Indian company, LLP or partnership controlled by resident Indian citizens; HQ in India
- Technology at TRL 4 or higher
- Priority sectors: energy transition, deep tech, AI, biotech & medtech, digital economy and agriculture

HOW TO APPLY

1. Check sector fit on the RDI portal
2. Apply through TDB's e-techcom portal (or BIRAC for biotech)
3. Technical and financial due diligence, then milestone-based tranches

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Detailed project report (DPR) with cost estimates
- ☐ Financial statements / ITRs for the last 2–3 years (if any)
- ☐ Patent or IP filings, or a prior-art search (if any)
- ☐ Cap table / shareholding pattern
- ☐ Proof of prototype or PoC — photos, video, test data
- ☐ Board resolution authorising the application

Official: rdifund.anrf.gov.in Stacks with: TDB, BIG, DLI Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (TDB SLFM page; first disbursements 13 May 2026)

Technology Development Board Assistance

SUPPORT	Soft loans / equity up to 50% of project cost	TYPE	Loan, Equity
STAGE	Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Deep tech, Manufacturing & hardware, Biotech, health & pharma, Energy & climate
EFFORT	Competitive — pitch or jury	DPIIT NEEDED	No

TDB funds Indian companies commercialising indigenous or adapted technologies, through soft loans and equity. It also runs themed calls (for example for startups, clean energy and quantum) and is a fund manager for the RDI Fund.

WHAT YOU GET

- Soft loans on concessional terms and/or equity
- Typically up to 50% of the project cost

WHO CAN APPLY

- Indian company with a technology ready to be commercialised
- Promoter contribution for the remaining project cost

HOW TO APPLY

1. Apply on TDB's online portal against an open call or the rolling window
2. Technical and financial appraisal, then an agreement with milestones

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Detailed project report (DPR) with cost estimates
- ☐ Financial statements / ITRs for the last 2–3 years (if any)
- ☐ Patent or IP filings, or a prior-art search (if any)
- ☐ Proof of prototype or PoC — photos, video, test data

Official: tdb.gov.in Stacks with: RDI Fund, PRAYAS Checked: Standing scheme; verified Sep 2026

IndiaAI Compute (subsidised GPUs)

SUPPORT	38,000+ GPUs at subsidised hourly rates	TYPE	Compute, Subsidy
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Software & AI, Deep tech
EFFORT	Simple — online form	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

Under the ₹10,372 crore IndiaAI Mission, Indian startups, researchers and students can rent high-end GPUs through the AI compute portal at heavily subsidised rates, instead of paying global cloud prices.

WHAT YOU GET

- Access to a common pool of 38,000+ GPUs
- Hourly rates far below market cloud pricing
- Also: the AIKosh dataset platform and IndiaAI innovation challenges

WHO CAN APPLY

- Indian startups, MSMEs, academia and students working on AI

HOW TO APPLY

1. Register on the IndiaAI compute portal
2. Submit your use case and compute requirement
3. Get allotted GPU hours and pay the subsidised rate

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN
- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget

CENTRAL · INDIA SEMICONDUCTOR MISSION, MEITY

OPEN · ROLLING

Semicon 2.0 – Design Linked Incentive (DLI)

SUPPORT	Was 50% up to ₹15 cr; revamped Sep 2026	TYPE	Grant, Equity, Subsidy
STAGE	Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Deep tech, Manufacturing & hardware
EFFORT	Competitive — pitch or jury	DPIIT NEEDED	No

New Semicon 2.0 terms notified week of 9 Sep 2026

Support for chip-design startups. The 2021 DLI reimbursed up to 50% of eligible design costs (capped at ₹15 crore) plus deployment incentives. The Semicon 2.0 revamp in September 2026 adds government co-investment alongside VCs, royalty-based financing and a 9% deployment-linked incentive on chip sales for five years (capped at ₹30 crore).

WHAT YOU GET

- Co-investment with VCs above the old ₹15 crore cap
- Royalty financing: repay 5% of net product revenue up to 1.5× the support
- Deployment incentive of 9% on chip sales for 5 years, up to ₹30 crore
- Access to EDA tools and design infrastructure

WHO CAN APPLY

- Indian startups and MSMEs designing semiconductor ICs, chipsets, SoCs or IP cores

HOW TO APPLY

1. Register on the ISM DLI portal
2. Submit a design project proposal
3. Review by ISM, then milestone-linked support

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Detailed project report (DPR) with cost estimates
- ☐ Financial statements / ITRs for the last 2–3 years (if any)
- ☐ Patent or IP filings, or a prior-art search (if any)
- ☐ Cap table / shareholding pattern

CENTRAL · DEPT OF TELECOMMUNICATIONS (DIGITAL BHARAT NIDHI)

OPENS IN ROUNDS

Telecom Technology Development Fund

SUPPORT	R&D grants by call (₹542 cr approved across 136 projects)	TYPE	Grant
STAGE	Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Telecom, Deep tech
EFFORT	Competitive — pitch or jury	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Funds indigenous telecom R&D – 5G/6G, network equipment, satellite communication, quantum communication – through calls for proposals. Startups can apply alone or in consortia with academia.

WHAT YOU GET

- Grants for telecom product R&D and pilots
- Consortium projects with IITs and R&D labs are encouraged

WHO CAN APPLY

- Indian startups, MSMEs, academia, R&D institutions and consortia

HOW TO APPLY

1. Watch the TTDF portal for open calls
2. Submit a proposal matching a call's topic
3. Technical review, then milestone-based funding

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Detailed project report (DPR) with cost estimates

☐ Financial statements / ITRs for the last 2–3 years (if any)

☐ Patent or IP filings, or a prior-art search (if any)

Official: ttdf.usof.gov.in

Stacks with: RDI Fund

Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (136 projects, ₹542 cr approved by Dec 2025)

Biotech, health & pharma

BIRAC, DBT and Department of Pharmaceuticals programmes.

CENTRAL · BIRAC, DEPT OF BIOTECHNOLOGY

OPENS IN ROUNDS

BIRAC Biotechnology Ignition Grant

SUPPORT	Up to ₹50 lakh	TYPE	Grant
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue	SECTOR	Biotech, health & pharma
EFFORT	Competitive — pitch or jury	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

Two calls a year, opening 1 Jan and 1 Jul (~45 days each)

India's best-known early-stage biotech grant: up to ₹50 lakh over 18 months to establish proof of concept for a life-sciences idea.

WHAT YOU GET

- Up to ₹50 lakh grant-in-aid
- 18-month project with mentoring from BIG partners

WHO CAN APPLY

- Startups, companies and individual researchers/innovators in biotech, medtech, agri-bio and related areas
- Individuals must incorporate before the grant is released

HOW TO APPLY

1. Apply online during the January or July call
2. Screening, then presentation to the expert committee
3. Sign the agreement with your BIG partner incubator

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget
- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN
- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Patent or IP filings, or a prior-art search (if any)
- ☐ Educational certificates of the founders

Official: birac.nic.in/big.php

Stacks with: BIRAC SEED, SIPP, BioE3 Challenge

Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (birac.nic.in)

CENTRAL · BIRAC (VIA BIONEST PARTNER INCUBATORS)

OPENS IN ROUNDS

BIRAC SEED Fund

SUPPORT	Up to ₹30 lakh equity	TYPE	Equity
STAGE	Early revenue	SECTOR	Biotech, health & pharma
EFFORT	Competitive — pitch or jury	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Equity support for biotech startups that have completed proof of concept, bridging the gap until angel or VC money arrives.

WHAT YOU GET

- Up to ₹30 lakh equity via a partner BioNEST incubator

WHO CAN APPLY

- Post-PoC biotech startup incubated at one of 16 SEED partner incubators

HOW TO APPLY

1. Get incubated at a BIRAC SEED partner (e.g., C-CAMP, IIT Bombay, IIT Delhi)
2. Apply through the incubator

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction

- ☐ Proof of prototype or PoC — photos, video, test data
- ☐ Cap table / shareholding pattern
- ☐ Patent or IP filings, or a prior-art search (if any)

Official: www.birac.nic.in/seedFundNew.php

Stacks with: BIG, LEAP

Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (birac.nic.in)

CENTRAL · BIRAC (VIA PARTNER INCUBATORS)

[OPENS IN ROUNDS](#)

BIRAC LEAP Fund

SUPPORT	Up to ₹100 lakh equity	TYPE	Equity
STAGE	Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Biotech, health & pharma
EFFORT	Competitive — pitch or jury	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Equity for biotech startups with a product close to commercialisation, to fund market launch and scale-up.

WHAT YOU GET

- Up to ₹1 crore equity through a partner incubator

WHO CAN APPLY

- Biotech startup with a product ready for commercialisation, incubated at a LEAP partner

HOW TO APPLY

1. Apply via a LEAP partner incubator
2. Due diligence and investment committee

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction
- ☐ Financial statements / ITRs for the last 2–3 years (if any)
- ☐ Cap table / shareholding pattern
- ☐ Patent or IP filings, or a prior-art search (if any)

Official: birac.nic.in

Stacks with: BIRAC SEED, RDI Fund

Checked: Standingscheme

CENTRAL · BIRAC

[OPENS IN ROUNDS](#)

BIRAC SBIRI & BIPP (industry R&D)

SUPPORT	Grants + soft loans, sized by project	TYPE	Grant, Loan
STAGE	Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Biotech, health & pharma
EFFORT	Competitive — pitch or jury	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Cost-shared R&D funding for biotech companies: SBIRI for early-stage, higher-risk research by small firms, and BIPP for later-stage, high-impact product development.

WHAT YOU GET

- Grants for early-stage R&D; soft loans for later stages
- Access to BIRAC's validation and mentoring network

WHO CAN APPLY

- Indian biotech companies (startups and SMEs) with in-house R&D

HOW TO APPLY

1. Apply against an open BIRAC call
2. Expert review and site visit

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Detailed project report (DPR) with cost estimates
- ☐ Financial statements / ITRs for the last 2–3 years (if any)
- ☐ Patent or IP filings, or a prior-art search (if any)

CENTRAL · BIRAC

OPENS IN ROUNDS

BIRAC student programmes (SITARE-GYTI, E-YUVA)

SUPPORT	Up to ₹15 lakh (GYTI awards)	TYPE	Grant, Stipend, Challenge / prize
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue	SECTOR	Biotech, health & pharma
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

BIRAC's routes for students: SITARE-GYTI awards up to ₹15 lakh for outstanding student innovations, and E-YUVA centres offering fellowships and pre-incubation in universities.

WHAT YOU GET

- Awards up to ₹15 lakh to take student projects forward
- Fellowships and lab access via E-YUVA centres

WHO CAN APPLY

- Students and young researchers in life sciences, engineering or medicine

HOW TO APPLY

1. Apply to the annual GYTI/SITARE call with your project
2. Or join an E-YUVA centre at a participating university

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Student ID or bonafide certificate from your institution
- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget
- ☐ Educational certificates of the founders

Official: birac.nic.in Stacks with: BIG, PRAYAS Checked: Amounts per BIRAC calls; confirm on the current call

CENTRAL · DEPT OF BIOTECHNOLOGY

OPENS IN ROUNDS

D.E.S.I.G.N. for BioE3 Challenge

SUPPORT	₹1 lakh–₹25 lakh	TYPE	Challenge / prize, Grant
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue	SECTOR	Biotech, health & pharma, Energy & climate
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

ADBT challenge under the BioE3 (Biotechnology for Economy, Environment and Employment) policy, rewarding students and startups for biomanufacturing and bio-based solutions.

WHAT YOU GET

- Prizes and grants from ₹1 lakh to ₹25 lakh
- Mentoring and incubation links

WHO CAN APPLY

- Students, researchers and early startups

HOW TO APPLY

1. Register for the current challenge round on the DBT site
2. Submit your design; shortlisted teams get support to build it

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget
- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN
- ☐ Student ID or bonafide certificate from your institution

Official: dbtindia.gov.in Stacks with: BIG, SITARE Checked: Listed as open in Sep 2026 (secondary source)

PRIP – Research & Innovation in Pharma-MedTech

SUPPORT	Up to ₹5 cr for startups	TYPE	Grant
STAGE	Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Biotech, health & pharma
EFFORT	Competitive — pitch or jury	DPIIT NEEDED	No

A ₹5,000 crore scheme funding new medicines, complex generics, biosimilars and novel medical devices. Early-stage projects by startups get 100% funding on the first ₹1 crore and 50% beyond that, up to ₹5 crore.

WHAT YOU GET

- Early-stage projects (up to ₹9 crore cost): up to ₹5 crore — 100% of the first ₹1 crore, 50% thereafter
- Later-stage industry projects: up to ₹100 crore
- Priority for rare diseases, AMR and outbreak pathogens

WHO CAN APPLY

- Startups, MSMEs and companies in pharma and medtech; academia collaborations welcome

HOW TO APPLY

1. Apply on the PRIP portal against the current call
2. Expert evaluation and approval

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Detailed project report (DPR) with cost estimates
- ☐ Financial statements / ITRs for the last 2–3 years (if any)
- ☐ Patent or IP filings, or a prior-art search (if any)

Official: prip.pharma-dept.gov.in

Stacks with: BIG, SHAKTI

Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (PIB, 1 Oct 2025 call)

Biopharma SHAKTI

SUPPORT	₹10,000 cr over 5 years	TYPE	Grant, Equity
STAGE	Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Biotech, health & pharma
EFFORT	Competitive — pitch or jury	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Announced in Budget 2026-27; guidelines and portal pending

A Budget 2026-27 programme to build India's biologics and biosimilars industry: new NIPERs, 1,000+ accredited clinical-trial sites, a stronger drug regulator, and early-stage grants and equity for biopharma startups.

WHAT YOU GET

- Early-stage grants and equity for biologics, biosimilars and cell & gene therapy
- Access to clinical-trial networks and NIPER facilities

WHO CAN APPLY

- Biopharma startups, MSMEs and research institutions (final criteria awaited)

HOW TO APPLY

1. Watch pharma-dept.gov.in for guidelines
2. Keep your DPR and regulatory plan ready

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Detailed project report (DPR) with cost estimates
- ☐ Patent or IP filings, or a prior-art search (if any)

Official: pharma-dept.gov.in

Stacks with: PRIP, BIG

Checked: Verified Sep 2026: not yet open

Agriculture & food

Agri-tech grants, agri funds and food-processing subsidies.

CENTRAL · MINISTRY OF AGRICULTURE (VIA 24 R-ABIS AND 5 KNOWLEDGE PARTNERS)

OPENS IN ROUNDS

RKVY Agri-Startup Programme (formerly RKVY-RAFTAAR)

SUPPORT	₹5 L (idea) + ₹25 L (seed)	TYPE	Grant, Incubation
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Agri & food
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

The main central grant for agri-tech and allied startups — precision farming, farm machinery, food tech, supply chain, dairy, fisheries — delivered through agribusiness incubators at agricultural universities and institutes.

WHAT YOU GET

- Up to ₹5 lakh at idea/pre-seed stage
- Up to ₹25 lakh at seed stage
- Incubation, training and mentoring

WHO CAN APPLY

- Agri and allied-sector startups and entrepreneurs, selected by an R-ABI or knowledge partner (e.g., MANAGE, NIAM, IARI)

HOW TO APPLY

1. Find the R-ABI or knowledge partner near you
2. Apply to its cohort call
3. Training programme, then pitch for the grant

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget
- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN
- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction

Official: rkvystartups.nic.in

Stacks with: AgriSURE, AIF (Agri), PMFME

Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (programme page)

CENTRAL · NABARD (NABVENTURES) WITH MINISTRY OF AGRICULTURE

OPEN · ROLLING

AgriSURE Fund

SUPPORT	Tickets up to ~₹25 cr	TYPE	Equity
STAGE	Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Agri & food, Energy & climate
EFFORT	Competitive — pitch or jury	DPIIT NEEDED	No

A blended fund for agri and rural startups: it invests in agri-focused AIFs and also directly in startups, from early stage to Series A.

WHAT YOU GET

- Equity or equity-linked investment
- Fund-of-funds route via agri-focused VC funds and a direct investment window

WHO CAN APPLY

- Startups in agriculture, allied sectors and rural enterprise with a scalable model

HOW TO APPLY

1. Apply through the NABVENTURES AgriSURE page
2. Or pitch an AgriSURE-backed AIF

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction
- ☐ Financial statements / ITRs for the last 2–3 years (if any)

☐ Cap table / shareholding pattern

Official: nabventures.in/agrisure.aspx

Stacks with: RKVY, FoF 2.0

Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (₹200 cr approvals by early 2026)

CENTRAL • MINISTRY OF AGRICULTURE

OPEN • ROLLING

Agriculture Infrastructure Fund

SUPPORT	Loans up to ₹2 cr with 3% interest subvention	TYPE	Loan, Subsidy, Credit guarantee
STAGE	Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Agri & food
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Cheaper, guaranteed loans for post-harvest and farm infrastructure — warehouses, cold chains, sorting and grading units, primary processing — which agri startups can use too.

WHAT YOU GET

- 3% annual interest subvention on loans up to ₹2 crore
- Credit guarantee cover on eligible loans

WHO CAN APPLY

- Agri-entrepreneurs, startups, FPOs, cooperatives and companies building eligible farm infrastructure

HOW TO APPLY

1. Apply on the AIF portal
2. Your chosen bank appraises and sanctions the loan

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Detailed project report (DPR) with cost estimates
- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Bank statements for the last 6–12 months
- ☐ Premises proof — rent agreement or ownership papers
- ☐ Quotations for machinery or equipment

Official: agriinfra.dac.gov.in

Stacks with: RKVY, PMFME

Checked: Standing scheme

CENTRAL • MINISTRY OF FOOD PROCESSING INDUSTRIES

CLOSES 30 SEP 2026

PM Formalisation of Micro Food Processing Enterprises

SUPPORT	35% subsidy, up to ₹10 lakh	TYPE	Subsidy, Loan
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Agri & food
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Valid till 30 Sep 2026; 5-year extension proposed

A credit-linked capital subsidy for small food businesses — pickles, bakery, millets, spices, dairy products — to buy machinery and upgrade.

WHAT YOU GET

- 35% credit-linked subsidy on project cost, up to ₹10 lakh per unit
- Branding, marketing and training support

WHO CAN APPLY

- Micro food processing units (individuals, proprietors, partnerships, FPOs, SHGs)

HOW TO APPLY

1. Apply on the PMFME portal (District Resource Persons help prepare the DPR)
2. Bank sanctions the loan; subsidy is credited to the loan account

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Detailed project report (DPR) with cost estimates
- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN
- ☐ Bank statements for the last 6–12 months
- ☐ Quotations for machinery or equipment
- ☐ Udyam (MSME) registration certificate

Defence, space, railways & textiles

Mission-driven programmes with a government customer at the end.

CENTRAL · INNOVATIONS FOR DEFENCE EXCELLENCE, MINISTRY OF DEFENCE

CLOSES 30 SEP 2026

iDEX Defence Startup Challenges (DISC & Open Challenge)

SUPPORT	Up to ₹1.5 crore	TYPE	Grant, Challenge / prize, Govt buyer
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Defence, Deep tech, Space
EFFORT	Competitive — pitch or jury	DPIIT NEEDED	No

iDEX Open Challenge 2026 closes 30 Sep 2026

The Ministry of Defence's front door for startups. Solve a problem set by the armed forces, DRDO or defence PSUs and get a non-dilutive grant of up to ₹1.5 crore, trials with the users, and a path to procurement.

WHAT YOU GET

- Grant up to ₹1.5 crore (no equity taken)
- Direct access to Army, Navy, Air Force, DRDO and DPSUs for trials
- Identified procurement pathway after success

WHO CAN APPLY

- Indian startups, MSMEs and individual innovators (must incorporate before signing)

HOW TO APPLY

1. Browse challenges on the iDEX portal
2. Submit a technical proposal
3. Screening, pitch to the jury, then an SPARK grant agreement with milestones

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction
- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN
- ☐ Patent or IP filings, or a prior-art search (if any)

Official: index.gov.in Stacks with: ADITI, TDF, SIPP Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (deadline 30 Sep 2026)

CENTRAL · MINISTRY OF DEFENCE

OPENS IN ROUNDS

iDEX ADITI (deep-tech defence)

SUPPORT	Up to ₹25 crore (50% of product budget)	TYPE	Grant
STAGE	Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Defence, Deep tech
EFFORT	Competitive — pitch or jury	DPIIT NEEDED	Yes

For critical and strategic defence technologies — AI, quantum, autonomous systems, satcom, semiconductors and cyber — ADITI funds up to half of a product development budget, to a maximum of ₹25 crore.

WHAT YOU GET

- Grant up to 50% of product development budget, max ₹25 crore
- Pathway to procurement by the armed forces

HOW TO APPLY

1. Apply against ADITI challenges on the iDEX portal
2. Evaluation and pitch; milestone-based grant

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ DPIIT recognition certificate

WHO CAN APPLY

- DPIIT-recognised startups and MSMEs; individuals must form a startup before signing

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Detailed project report (DPR) with cost estimates
- ☐ Financial statements / ITRs for the last 2–3 years (if any)
- ☐ Patent or IP filings, or a prior-art search (if any)

Official: www.ddpmod.gov.in/en/offerings/schemes-and-services/aditi_details

Stacks with: iDEX, TDF

Checked: Scheme period ran to FY2025-26; check iDEX for current ADITI rounds

CENTRAL · DRDO, MINISTRY OF DEFENCE

OPEN · ROLLING

DRDO Technology Development Fund

SUPPORT	Up to ₹50 crore per project	TYPE	Grant
STAGE	Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Defence, Deep tech, Manufacturing & hardware
EFFORT	Competitive — pitch or jury	DPIIT NEEDED	No

DRDO funds Indian industry, especially MSMEs and startups, to develop defence technologies that are not yet made in India, with DRDO scientists as mentors.

WHAT YOU GET

- Grant up to ₹50 crore per project
- DRDO mentoring and test facilities

WHO CAN APPLY

- Indian MSMEs and startups (can partner with academia)
- Project must match a TDF-listed technology need

HOW TO APPLY

1. Check open topics on the TDF portal
2. Submit a proposal for the listed technology
3. Technical evaluation and project monitoring by DRDO

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Detailed project report (DPR) with cost estimates
- ☐ Financial statements / ITRs for the last 2–3 years (if any)
- ☐ Udyam (MSME) registration certificate

Official: tdf.drdo.gov.in

Stacks with: iDEX, ADITI

Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (limit raised to ₹50 cr, PIB 2022)

CENTRAL · DRDO

OPENS IN ROUNDS

DRDO Dare to Dream Innovation Contest

SUPPORT	Prizes up to ₹10 lakh	TYPE	Challenge / prize
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue	SECTOR	Defence, Deep tech
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

A contest for individuals and startups with ideas for emerging defence technologies. Winners receive cash prizes and a route into DRDO programmes.

WHAT YOU GET

- Cash prizes (up to ₹10 lakh for startups)
- Recognition and DRDO connections

WHO CAN APPLY

- Indian individuals and startups

HOW TO APPLY

1. Watch the DRDO site for the next edition
2. Submit your idea in the listed technology areas

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget
- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN

CENTRAL · IN-SPACE, DEPT OF SPACE

OPEN · ROLLING

IN-SPACe Seed Fund Scheme

SUPPORT	Seed support for space startups (₹65 cr envelope)	TYPE	Grant
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Space
EFFORT	Competitive — pitch or jury	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Active FY2024-27; ₹3.3 cr disbursed by Jul 2026

Seed funding for early space-tech startups to build proofs of concept and prototypes, with access to ISRO facilities and expertise through IN-SPACe.

WHAT YOU GET

- Seed grants for PoC/prototype (per-startup support of up to about ₹1 crore)
- Access to ISRO test facilities and technical mentoring

WHO CAN APPLY

- Indian space-tech startups (non-governmental entities)

HOW TO APPLY

1. Register on the IN-SPACe portal
2. Apply under the seed fund call
3. Evaluation by IN-SPACe technical committee

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction
- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN

Official: www.inspace.gov.in Stacks with: Space VC Fund, TAF Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (Parliament reply, Aug 2026)

CENTRAL · IN-SPACE, DEPT OF SPACE

OPEN · ROLLING

IN-SPACe Technology Adoption Fund

SUPPORT	₹500 cr fund; up to ₹25 cr per project	TYPE	Grant
STAGE	Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Space
EFFORT	Competitive — pitch or jury	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Co-funds space companies to take technologies to commercial products — covering a share of project cost for startups and MSMEs.

WHAT YOU GET

- Up to 60% of project cost for startups and MSMEs (40% for larger companies)
- Up to ₹25 crore per project

WHO CAN APPLY

- Indian non-governmental space entities with a technology ready to commercialise

HOW TO APPLY

1. Apply on the IN-SPACe TAF page
2. Evaluation and milestone-based support

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Detailed project report (DPR) with cost estimates
- ☐ Financial statements / ITRs for the last 2–3 years (if any)
- ☐ Patent or IP filings, or a prior-art search (if any)

CENTRAL · IN-SPACE (MANAGED BY SIDBI VENTURE CAPITAL)

OPEN · ROLLING

Space Sector Venture Capital Fund

SUPPORT	₹1,000 cr fund	TYPE	Equity
STAGE	Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Space
EFFORT	Competitive — pitch or jury	DPIIT NEEDED	No

A ₹1,000 crore government VC fund investing only in Indian space startups, from early stage to growth. SEBI approval came in October 2025 and it has already invested about ₹189 crore.

WHAT YOU GET

- Equity investment in space startups
- Signals credibility to co-investors

WHO CAN APPLY

- Indian space-tech startups with a scalable technology

HOW TO APPLY

1. Pitch the fund manager (SIDBI Venture Capital)
2. Due diligence and investment committee

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction
- ☐ Financial statements / ITRs for the last 2–3 years (if any)
- ☐ Cap table / shareholding pattern

CENTRAL · MINISTRY OF RAILWAYS

OPEN · ROLLING

Rail Tech Policy (Startups for Railways)

SUPPORT	Up to 50% of project cost + order pipeline	TYPE	Grant, Govt buyer
STAGE	Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Railways & mobility, Deep tech
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Launched 27 Feb 2026, modelled on iDEX: a 24×7 Rail Tech portal where startups propose solutions to Railways' problems (safety, AI, drones, track and stress monitoring). Railways funds up to half the project and promises large orders after success.

WHAT YOU GET

- Up to 50% funding of approved projects
- Prototype and scale-up grants raised (prototype limits doubled, scale-up more than tripled)
- Long-term orders for successful solutions

WHO CAN APPLY

- Startups, innovators and institutions solving a listed Railways problem

HOW TO APPLY

1. Browse problem statements on the Rail Tech portal
2. Submit a single-stage detailed proposal
3. Evaluation, trials and scale-up

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction

GREAT – Technical Textiles Startups

SUPPORT	Up to ₹50 lakh	TYPE	Grant
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Manufacturing & hardware
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

Grant for Research & Entrepreneurship across Aspiring Innovators in Technical Textiles: funds students and startups turning technical-textile ideas (medical, protective, agro, geo textiles) into products.

WHAT YOU GET

- Grant up to ₹50 lakh per startup
- Mentoring via partner institutes

WHO CAN APPLY

- Individuals, students and startups working on technical textiles

HOW TO APPLY

1. Apply through the Ministry of Textiles call
2. Evaluation by the empowered programme committee

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget
- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN
- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)

Official: texmin.nic.in Stacks with: MSME Innovative Checked: Grants of ₹50 lakh approved in 2024-25 rounds

State & UT schemes, A–Z

Register on your state's startup portal first – most state incentives need it. Rankings are from the 5th States' Startup Ecosystem Ranking (January 2026).

Andaman & Nicobar Islands

RANKING 2026: ASPIRING LEADER

ANDAMAN & NICOBAR ISLANDS · A&N ADMINISTRATION

OPEN · ROLLING

Andaman & Nicobar Startup Scheme

SUPPORT	Pro-bono services for pitch winners	TYPE	Mentoring & network, Challenge / prize
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Simple — online form	DPIIT NEEDED	No

India's first UT startup policy (Dec 2018). Pitch competition winners get free help with incorporation, tax registrations and media services.

WHAT YOU GET

- Free incorporation, GST/TAN/PAN and filing help for winners

WHO CAN APPLY

- Founders in the Andaman & Nicobar Islands

HOW TO APPLY

1. Take part in the UT's startup pitch events

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN
- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget

Official: as.and.nic.in/startupindia

Stacks with: Mudra, PMEGP

State ranking 2026: Aspiring Leader

Checked: Per Invest India summary

Andhra Pradesh

RANKING 2026: LEADER

ANDHRA PRADESH · ITE&C DEPT, GOVT OF ANDHRA PRADESH

OPEN · ROLLING

AP Innovation & Startup Policy 4.0 (2024-29)

SUPPORT	₹2 L prototype · ₹15–20 L scale-up · up to ₹2 cr seed	TYPE	Grant, Equity, IP support
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Any sector, Deep tech
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

Aims for 20,000 startups and 10 unicorns by 2029 through the Ratan Tata Innovation Hub network, 10 centres of excellence and staged grants from student prototypes to seed investment.

WHAT YOU GET

- Prototype grant up to ₹2 lakh (open to students)
- Scale-up grant up to ₹15 lakh (₹20 lakh for women-led)
- RTIH incubation support up to ₹30 lakh
- RTIH–SIDBI seed fund (₹22 crore; up to ₹2 crore per startup) and a ₹20 crore deep-tech seed fund

HOW TO APPLY

1. Register on the AP innovation portal
2. Apply for the relevant grant; pitch to the technical committee

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)

- 50% of international patent costs, up to ₹10 lakh

WHO CAN APPLY

- Startups and student innovators based in Andhra Pradesh

☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state

☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction

☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget

☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN

Official: rtih.co.in Stacks with: RTIH, SIPP State ranking 2026: Leader

Checked: Amounts per policy summaries (2025); verify on the portal

ANDHRA PRADESH · GOVT OF ANDHRA PRADESH

OPEN · ROLLING

Ratan Tata Innovation Hub

SUPPORT	Free plug-and-play space + programmes	TYPE	Incubation
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

A hub-and-spoke innovation network with its main hub in Amaravati and five regional centres, offering workspace, mentoring and access to AP's startup grants.

WHAT YOU GET

- Free plug-and-play office space
- Mentors, investor connects and policy grants

WHO CAN APPLY

- AP-based startups and innovators

HOW TO APPLY

1. Apply on the RTIH website

DOCUMENTS

☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction

Official: rtih.co.in

Stacks with: AP Policy 4.0

State ranking 2026: Leader

Checked: Verified Sep 2026

Arunachal Pradesh

RANKING 2026: BEST PERFORMER

ARUNACHAL PRADESH · DEPT OF PLANNING, INVESTMENT & FINANCE, GOVT OF ARUNACHAL PRADESH

OPENS IN ROUNDS

Arunachal Pradesh State Startup Policy

SUPPORT	₹5 L support grant · PoC ₹10 L · scale-up to ₹25 L	TYPE	Grant, IP support
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No

An annual support-grant competition plus proof-of-concept, R&D, certification and scale-up support. Arunachal was a Best Performer in the 2026 rankings.

WHAT YOU GET

- Support grant: ₹5 lakh (top 10) or ₹4 lakh (next 40) each year, with incubation
- PoC support up to ₹10 lakh (state) where SISFS isn't used
- R&D up to ₹5 lakh; quality certification up to ₹5 lakh

HOW TO APPLY

1. Register on the Arunachal startup portal
2. Apply to the annual support-grant call

DOCUMENTS

☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)

- Scale-up reimbursement up to ₹25 lakh; digital upscaling up to ₹10 lakh

WHO CAN APPLY

- Startups in Arunachal Pradesh

- ☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction
- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget

Official: www.startup.arunachal.gov.in

Stacks with: SIPP

State ranking 2026: Best Performer

Checked: Per 2022-23 policy coverage

Assam

RANKING 2026: ASPIRING LEADER

ASSAM · INDUSTRIES, COMMERCE & PE DEPT, GOVT OF ASSAM

OPEN · ROLLING

Assam Start-up & Innovation Policy 2025

SUPPORT	₹10 L idea → ₹25 L pilot → ₹50 L scale-up	TYPE	Grant, Stipend, Tax relief, IP support
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Replaces the 2017 policy with staged grants, a monthly allowance and reimbursements, targeting 5,000 startups and 1 lakh jobs in five years.

WHAT YOU GET

- Idea2PoC grant up to ₹10 lakh; piloting (MVP) grant up to ₹25 lakh; scale-up grant up to ₹50 lakh
- Sustenance allowance ₹20,000/month (+₹5,000 for women/SC/ST/Divyang-led)
- GST reimbursement up to ₹5 lakh/year for 3 years; 50% lease rental up to ₹5 lakh
- Patents: ₹1 lakh (domestic), ₹5 lakh (international); 50% marketing costs up to ₹2 lakh

WHO CAN APPLY

- Startups registered in Assam

Official: assamramp.com/ramp/innovationpolicy

Stacks with: SIPP

Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (policy page)

HOW TO APPLY

1. Register on the Assam Udyog Setu / RAMP portal
2. Apply for each grant stage

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction
- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget

State ranking 2026: Aspiring Leader

Bihar

RANKING 2026: ASPIRING LEADER

BIHAR · DEPT OF INDUSTRIES, GOVT OF BIHAR

OPEN · ROLLING

Bihar Startup Policy 2022

SUPPORT	₹10 L interest-free for 10 years + ₹3 L matching	TYPE	Loan, Grant
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

Bihar's seed fund gives up to ₹10 lakh as an interest-free loan repayable over 10 years, plus matching grants when you raise angel or VC money, free co-working space and acceleration support.

WHAT YOU GET

- Seed fund up to ₹10 lakh, interest-free for 10 years
- Matching grant up to ₹3 lakh after raising angel/VC funds
- Free co-working space at state incubators; acceleration programme support

WHO CAN APPLY

- Pvt Ltd, LLP or partnership registered in Bihar, up to 10 years old
- Turnover under ₹100 crore; innovative product or process

HOW TO APPLY

1. Register on the Startup Bihar portal
2. Pitch to the expert panel
3. Disbursement after approval

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction
- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN

Official: startup.bihar.gov.in Stacks with: SIPP, CGSS State ranking 2026: Aspiring Leader Checked: Per secondary sources (2026)

Chandigarh

RANKING 2026: EMERGING

CHANDIGARH · UT ADMINISTRATION, CHANDIGARH

ANNOUNCED — NOT YET OPEN

Chandigarh Startup Policy 2025

SUPPORT	₹7 L seed · ₹12 L early-growth	TYPE	Grant, Challenge / prize
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

Cleared by the department (Mar 2025); confirm notification

A ₹50 crore, five-year policy with a startup competition, seed and early-growth grants and small reimbursements, run largely through campus incubators.

WHAT YOU GET

- Competition: ₹2 lakh for top 20, ₹1 lakh for next 50
- Seed grant up to ₹7 lakh (₹9 lakh women/transgender-led); early-growth up to ₹12 lakh
- Rent support ₹5,000/month; certification, patent and conference reimbursements

HOW TO APPLY

1. Watch the UT administration site for the call

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state

WHO CAN APPLY

- Startups in Chandigarh

☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction

Official: chandigarh.gov.in

Stacks with: SIPP

State ranking 2026: Emerging

Checked: Per Mar 2025 coverage; status to confirm

Chhattisgarh

RANKING 2026: EMERGING

CHHATTISGARH · DEPT OF COMMERCE & INDUSTRY, GOVT OF CHHATTISGARH

OPEN · ROLLING

Chhattisgarh Innovation & Startup Promotion Policy 2025-30

SUPPORT	₹100 cr capital fund; seed, interest subsidy, risk-free loans	TYPE	Grant, Loan, Equity
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Any sector, Agri & food
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

The 2025-30 policy offers seed funds, interest subsidies and risk-free loans across the startup lifecycle, with a ₹100 crore capital fund; idea-stage students are covered by a companion student startup policy.

WHAT YOU GET

- Seed funding, interest subsidy and risk-free loans
- ₹100 crore capital fund
- District boot camps across all 27 districts

WHO CAN APPLY

- Startups registered in Chhattisgarh

HOW TO APPLY

1. Register on the Startup Chhattisgarh portal
2. Apply as calls open (helpline 1800 233 3943)

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction

Official: invest.cg.gov.in/startup

Stacks with: SIPP

State ranking 2026: Emerging

Checked: Policy verified; exact amounts in the policy PDF

Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu

RANKING 2026: EMERGING

DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI AND DAMAN & DIU · UT ADMINISTRATION OF DNH & DD

OPEN · ROLLING

DNH & DD Investment Promotion Scheme 2022-27 (startups)

SUPPORT	15% capital subsidy up to ₹15-35 L	TYPE	Subsidy, IP support
STAGE	Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Manufacturing & hardware, Any sector
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No

The UT's industrial scheme (valid to 19 May 2027) gives extra interest subsidy to registered startups and young entrepreneurs, plus capital, certification and IP support.

WHAT YOU GET

- 15% capital subsidy: up to ₹15 lakh (micro), ₹30 lakh (small), ₹35 lakh (medium)
- Extra 10% interest subsidy for startups and entrepreneurs under 35
- 75% of patent/trademark costs up to ₹25 lakh; 50% of quality certification up to ₹10 lakh

WHO CAN APPLY

- Units in Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu

HOW TO APPLY

1. Apply to the District Industries Centre through the NSWS portal

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Udyam (MSME) registration certificate
- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Detailed project report (DPR) with cost estimates
- ☐ Invoices and payment receipts for costs you're claiming

Official: ddd.gov.in Stacks with: CGTMSE, SIPP State ranking 2026: Emerging

Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (States' Startup Ranking 5.0 report)

Delhi

RANKING 2026: EMERGING

DELHI · EDUCATION DEPT, GOVT OF NCT OF DELHI

ANNOUNCED — NOT YET OPEN

Delhi Start-up Policy 2026

SUPPORT	₹400 cr over 5 years	TYPE	Grant, Incubation
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

Approved by Cabinet 16 Jul 2026; detailed amounts awaited

Approved on 16 July 2026, Delhi's policy runs through its universities, colleges, polytechnics, ITIs and schools. Startups get milestone-based help from proof of concept to commercialisation, and institutions get money to build incubators. It aims to support 10,000 startups.

WHAT YOU GET

- Milestone support for proof of concept, prototype, product, market validation and commercialisation
- Incubation centres at state universities, colleges, polytechnics and ITIs
- The earlier draft suggested grants up to ₹10 lakh — final amounts yet to be published

HOW TO APPLY

1. Ask your institution's incubation centre about the rollout
2. Watch the Delhi government site for guidelines

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Student ID or bonafide certificate from your institution
- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget

WHO CAN APPLY

- Students and founders connected to Delhi government institutions

Official: www.delhi.gov.in Stacks with: IIC / NISP, PRAYAS State ranking 2026: Emerging
Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (Medianama, Sep 2026)

☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN

Goa

RANKING 2026: BEST PERFORMER

GOA · DEPT OF IT, E&C, GOVT OF GOA

OPEN · ROLLING

Goa Startup Policy 2025

SUPPORT	Seed up to ₹10 L + cost reimbursements	TYPE	Grant, Subsidy, IP support
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Any sector, Software & AI
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

Rolled out in late September 2025 (target: 1,000 startups and 10,000 jobs by 2028). Adds a Campus Innovation Scheme for students and skill reimbursements to Goa's established incentives. Goa was a Best Performer in the 2026 rankings.

WHAT YOU GET

- Campus Innovation Scheme grants for student projects
- Seed capital up to ₹10 lakh (under the 2021 policy framework)
- Lease rental, co-working seat, internet/cloud and salary reimbursements
- IPR: up to ₹2 lakh (national), ₹5 lakh (international)

WHO CAN APPLY

- Startups registered with StartUp Goa; students for the campus scheme

HOW TO APPLY

- Register on the StartUp Goa portal
- Apply for each incentive online

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction
- ☐ Invoices and payment receipts for costs you're claiming

Official: www.startup.goa.gov.in Stacks with: SIPP State ranking 2026: Best Performer
Checked: 2025 launch verified; some amounts from the 2021 incentive list

GUJARAT · INDUSTRIES COMMISSIONERATE, GOVT OF GUJARAT (VIA NODAL INSTITUTES)

OPENS IN ROUNDS

Gujarat Scheme for Assistance to Startups & Innovation

SUPPORT	Up to ₹30 L seed + ₹20-25k/month	TYPE	Grant, Stipend
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

Gujarat — ranked the best state for startups for the fifth time running — funds startups through approved nodal institutes such as GUSEC and iHub: seed grants for prototypes and patents, a monthly allowance for founders, and marketing support.

WHAT YOU GET

- Seed grant up to ₹30 lakh
- Sustenance allowance ₹20,000/month for a year (₹25,000 for women founders)
- Marketing support up to ₹10 lakh

WHO CAN APPLY

- Startups registered in Gujarat, incubated at an approved nodal institute

HOW TO APPLY

1. Join an approved nodal institute (e.g., GUSEC, iHub Gujarat)
2. Apply through the institute when applications open

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction
- ☐ Letter from your incubator confirming incubation
- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget

Official: gusec.edu.in/startup-gujarat-scheme

Stacks with: SSIP 2.0, SIPP

State ranking 2026: Best Performer

Checked: Amounts per nodal-institute page (2026)

GUJARAT · EDUCATION DEPT, GOVT OF GUJARAT

OPENS IN ROUNDS

Student Startup & Innovation Policy (SSIP 2.0)

SUPPORT	Up to ₹2.5 L per prototype + IPR costs	TYPE	Grant, IP support
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Simple — online form	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

Funds students from school to university: prototype grants through their institutions and up to 100% of IP filing costs.

WHAT YOU GET

- Up to ₹2.5 lakh per PoC/prototype (higher education); ₹20,000 for Classes 9–12
- IPR support: up to ₹75,000 (domestic patent), ₹1.5 lakh (international patent), plus trademark, copyright and design costs

WHO CAN APPLY

- Students and recent graduates of Gujarat institutions

HOW TO APPLY

1. Contact your institute's SSIP coordinator
2. Submit the proposal on the SSIP portal

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Student ID or bonafide certificate from your institution
- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget

Haryana

RANKING 2026: LEADER

HARYANA · DEPT OF IT, ELECTRONICS & COMMUNICATION, GOVT OF HARYANA

OPEN · ROLLING

Haryana State Startup Policy 2022

SUPPORT	Seed ₹10 L · patents up to ₹25 L	TYPE	Grant, Subsidy, IP support, Tax relief
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Seed grants graded by district category, generous patent reimbursement, lease and cloud subsidies, and SGST refunds for Haryana startups.

WHAT YOU GET

- Seed grant up to ₹10 lakh
- 100% patent costs reimbursed, up to ₹25 lakh
- Lease rental subsidy up to ₹5 lakh
- 75% of cloud costs up to ₹2.5 lakh a year for 5 years
- 50% net SGST reimbursement for 7 years
- Acceleration programmes: up to ₹2.5 lakh (national), ₹5 lakh (international)

WHO CAN APPLY

- Startups registered in Haryana

HOW TO APPLY

1. Register on the Startup Haryana portal
2. Apply for each incentive with supporting bills

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction
- ☐ Invoices and payment receipts for costs you're claiming

Official: startupharyana.gov.in Stacks with: SIPP, IndiaAI Compute State ranking 2026: Leader
Checked: Per policy coverage (2022); still listed on the state portal

Himachal Pradesh

RANKING 2026: TOP PERFORMER

HIMACHAL PRADESH · DEPT OF INDUSTRIES, GOVT OF HIMACHAL PRADESH

OPEN · ROLLING

Himachal CM Startup / Innovation Projects Scheme

SUPPORT	₹25,000 a month for a year	TYPE	Stipend, Incubation
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue	SECTOR	Any sector, Agri & food
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

Any individual or group with an innovative idea gets ₹25,000 a month for a year plus free incubation, mentoring and lab access at approved incubators. Himachal was a Top Performer in the 2026 rankings.

WHAT YOU GET

- Sustenance allowance ₹25,000/month for one year
- Free incubation, mentoring and labs

HOW TO APPLY

1. Register on the Startup Himachal portal
2. Get selected by an approved incubator

WHO CAN APPLY

- Any individual or group with an innovative idea (Himachal focus sectors include agri, food processing, tourism, IT, biotech)

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN
- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget
- ☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state

Official: emerginghimachal.hp.gov.in/startup Stacks with: PRAYAS, NIDHI-EIR State ranking 2026: Top Performer
Checked: Verified Sep 2026

Jammu & Kashmir

RANKING 2026: ASPIRING LEADER

JAMMU & KASHMIR · J&K ENTREPRENEURSHIP DEVELOPMENT INSTITUTE (JKEDI)

OPEN · ROLLING

J&K Start-up Policy 2024-27

SUPPORT	Seed grants up to ₹20 L · ₹250 cr VC fund	TYPE	Grant, Equity
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

Aims for 2,000 new startups by 2027 with seed grants, a ₹250 crore venture fund and extra support for women and differently-abled founders.

WHAT YOU GET

- Seed grants up to ₹20 lakh
- ₹250 crore venture capital fund
- Incubation through campus and state incubators

WHO CAN APPLY

- Startups registered in Jammu & Kashmir

HOW TO APPLY

- Register with JKEDI / the J&K startup portal
- Apply to the seed programme

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction

Official: jkindustriescommerce.nic.in Stacks with: SIPP State ranking 2026: Aspiring Leader Checked: Per policy coverage

Jharkhand

JHARKHAND · GOVT OF JHARKHAND (STARTUP JHARKHAND)

OPEN · ROLLING

Jharkhand Startup Policy 2023

SUPPORT	₹5,000/month per founder (up to 3)	TYPE	Stipend, Grant
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Simple — online form	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Sustenance allowance for founders plus seed, marketing and incubation support under the 2023 policy.

WHAT YOU GET

- ₹5,000/month per founder for up to 3 founders for 12 months
- Other seed, marketing and incubation incentives per the policy

WHO CAN APPLY

- Jharkhand-registered startups under 5 years old, turnover under ₹25 crore, with full-time founders

HOW TO APPLY

1. Apply on the Startup Jharkhand portal (rolling)

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state
- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN

Official: abvil.jharkhand.gov.in Stacks with: SIPP Checked: Per secondary source (2026)

Karnataka

RANKING 2026: TOP PERFORMER

KARNATAKA · DEPT OF ELECTRONICS, IT & BT, GOVT OF KARNATAKA

OPEN · ROLLING

Karnataka Startup Policy 2025-30

SUPPORT	₹675 cr outlay	TYPE	Grant, Equity, Govt buyer
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Any sector, Deep tech
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

Launched 19 January 2026 with a ₹675 crore outlay and a goal of 25,000 new startups by 2030 — at least 10,000 from outside Bengaluru. It bundles ELEVATE grants, a new ₹150 crore deep-tech programme, cluster seed funds and 'Government First' procurement.

WHAT YOU GET

- ELEVATE grants up to ₹50 lakh; ELEVATE NxT up to ₹1 crore for deep tech
- Beyond Bengaluru Cluster Seed Fund (₹75 crore) for Mysuru, Mangaluru and Hubballi-Dharwad
- 'Government First': state departments as a startup's first customer
- Incubation, mentoring, market access and global connects

WHO CAN APPLY

- Startups registered in Karnataka and recognised under the state's startup definition

HOW TO APPLY

1. Register on the Startup Karnataka portal
2. Apply to the specific programme (ELEVATE, NxT, cluster fund) when its call opens

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ DPIIT recognition certificate
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction
- ☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state

KARNATAKA · STARTUP KARNATAKA / K-TECH

OPENS IN ROUNDS

ELEVATE (Idea2PoC) Grant

SUPPORT	Up to ₹50 lakh	TYPE	Grant, Challenge / prize
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Competitive — pitch or jury	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Karnataka's flagship grant-in-aid challenge for early startups. The 2025 edition picked 146 winners with ₹38.85 crore of grants; 43% were women-led and 43% from beyond Bengaluru.

WHAT YOU GET

- Grant-in-aid up to ₹50 lakh, milestone-linked
- Mentoring and visibility through Startup Karnataka

WHO CAN APPLY

- Karnataka-registered startups with an innovative product or idea
- Turnover below ₹100 crore

HOW TO APPLY

1. Apply on the Startup Karnataka portal when the ELEVATE call opens
2. Screening, then pitch to the jury (Elevate Unnati is a parallel track for SC/ST founders)

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction
- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget
- ☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state
- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN

KARNATAKA · GOVT OF KARNATAKA

OPENS IN ROUNDS

ELEVATE NxT (deep tech)

SUPPORT	Up to ₹1 crore	TYPE	Grant
STAGE	Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Deep tech, Biotech, health & pharma, Energy & climate, Space
EFFORT	Competitive — pitch or jury	DPIIT NEEDED	No

A new ₹150 crore programme under the 2025-30 policy for deep-tech startups in AI, IoT, robotics, biotech, quantum, green energy and space tech, with milestone-based support up to ₹1 crore.

WHAT YOU GET

- Up to ₹1 crore per startup, released against milestones

WHO CAN APPLY

- Karnataka deep-tech startups

HOW TO APPLY

1. Watch the Startup Karnataka portal for the NxT call

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Detailed project report (DPR) with cost estimates
- ☐ Patent or IP filings, or a prior-art search (if any)
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction

KARNATAKA · GOVT OF KARNATAKA WITH PRIVATE PARTNERS

OPEN · ROLLING

Beyond Bengaluru Cluster Seed Fund

SUPPORT	₹75 cr fund; ~₹50 L per startup	TYPE	Equity
STAGE	Early revenue	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Competitive — pitch or jury	DPIIT NEEDED	No

A ₹75 crore seed fund (₹20 crore from the state plus private capital) investing in startups from Mysuru, Mangaluru and Hubballi-Dharwad clusters.

WHAT YOU GET

- Seed investment of about ₹50 lakh per startup (capped at 10% of the fund)

WHO CAN APPLY

- Startups based in the designated Karnataka clusters

HOW TO APPLY

- Pitch the fund through the cluster's startup hub

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction
- ☐ Cap table / shareholding pattern

KARNATAKA · K-TECH, GOVT OF KARNATAKA

OPENS IN ROUNDS

NAIN — New Age Incubation Network (colleges)

SUPPORT	Around ₹4–5 lakh per student project	TYPE	Grant, Incubation
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

Innovation centres in engineering and other colleges across Karnataka that fund student teams to build prototypes over six months.

WHAT YOU GET

- Project grants (recent college rounds: ₹4–5 lakh per project) for materials and prototyping
- Mentoring through the college NAIN centre

WHO CAN APPLY

- Full-time students of a college with a NAIN centre, in teams of 3–5

HOW TO APPLY

- Check if your college hosts a NAIN centre
- Submit a proposal during its annual ideathon

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Student ID or bonafide certificate from your institution
- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget

KSUM Innovation Grants (Idea, Productisation, Scale-up)

SUPPORT	₹3 L idea · ₹7 L product · ₹15 L scale-up	TYPE	Grant
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

Kerala's staged grants follow a startup from idea to revenue: an Idea Grant for prototypes, a Productisation Grant to finish the product, and a Scale-up Grant once you have revenue or investment.

WHAT YOU GET

- Idea Grant up to ₹3 lakh
- Productisation Grant up to ₹7 lakh (₹12 lakh for women-led startups)
- Scale-up Grant up to ₹15 lakh

WHO CAN APPLY

- Kerala-based startups with a KSUM Unique ID; incorporation needed before disbursement
- Scale-up: ₹10 lakh product revenue in the last 6 months or ₹30 lakh external equity
- Margin money: 20% (productisation) to 50% (scale-up)

HOW TO APPLY

1. Get a KSUM Unique ID
2. Apply on the KSUM grants portal
3. Pitch to the evaluation panel; funds released in tranches

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction
- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget
- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN

Official: startupmission.kerala.gov.in/schemes/idea-grant

Stacks with: KSUM Seed, IEDC, SIPP

State ranking 2026: Leader

Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (KSUM scheme pages)

KSUM Seed Fund (soft loan)

SUPPORT	Up to ₹15 lakh at 6%	TYPE	Loan
STAGE	Early revenue	SECTOR	Any sector, Software & AI
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	Yes

A soft loan of up to ₹15 lakh at 6% simple interest for product startups, with a 12-month moratorium and 36 monthly repayments.

WHAT YOU GET

- Up to ₹15 lakh at 6% simple interest
- 12-month moratorium, no prepayment penalty

WHO CAN APPLY

- Kerala LLP or private limited company with a KSUM ID and DPIIT recognition
- Innovative product or technology (not pure services or trading)

HOW TO APPLY

1. Apply on the KSUM portal
2. Evaluation and loan agreement

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ DPIIT recognition certificate
- ☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state

- ☐ Financial statements / ITRs for the last 2–3 years (if any)
- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN

Official: startupmission.kerala.gov.in/schemes/seed-fund

Stacks with: KSUM grants

State ranking 2026: Leader

Checked: Verified Sep 2026

KERALA · KERALA STARTUP MISSION (INNOVATION & ENTREPRENEURSHIP DEVELOPMENT CENTRES)

OPEN · ROLLING

KSUM IEDC Student Innovation Grants

SUPPORT	Up to ₹2 lakh per student idea	TYPE	Grant, Incubation
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Simple — online form	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

IEDCs in colleges across Kerala run bootcamps and fund student prototypes, with a path to KSUM's larger grants and patent support for student inventors.

WHAT YOU GET

- Idea grant up to ₹2 lakh for student projects
- Patent support and pre-incubation

WHO CAN APPLY

- Students of Kerala colleges with an IEDC

HOW TO APPLY

1. Join your college IEDC
2. Apply for the student idea grant through it

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Student ID or bonafide certificate from your institution
- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget

Official: startupmission.kerala.gov.in

Stacks with: KSUM grants, PRAYAS

State ranking 2026: Leader

Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (IEDC schemes page)

Ladakh

RANKING 2026: EMERGING

LADAKH · UT ADMINISTRATION OF LADAKH

OPEN · ROLLING

Ladakh Startup Incentives

SUPPORT	₹15k/month + ₹3 L MVP + ₹3 L marketing	TYPE	Stipend, Grant, IP support
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Any sector, Energy & climate
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	Yes

Stipends and grants for DPIIT-recognised Ladakh startups, with incubators in Leh and Kargil and full subsidies for green-energy solutions.

WHAT YOU GET

- Stipend ₹15,000/month for a year (₹20,000 for women and marginalised founders)
- MVP support up to ₹3 lakh; marketing up to ₹3 lakh
- Free workspace up to ₹1 lakh a year; 50% patent costs up to ₹5 lakh

WHO CAN APPLY

- DPIIT-recognised startups in Ladakh

HOW TO APPLY

1. Apply through the Ladakh industries department

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ DPIIT recognition certificate
- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state

Madhya Pradesh

RANKING 2026: LEADER

MADHYA PRADESH · MSME DEPT, GOVT OF MADHYA PRADESH

OPEN · ROLLING

MP Startup Policy & Implementation Scheme 2025

SUPPORT	Seed up to ₹30 L; 15% of funds raised (up to ₹60 L)	TYPE	Grant, Equity
STAGE	Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	Yes

A 2025 policy with a ₹100 crore Startup Capital Fund, seed support through empanelled incubators, and a cash top-up whenever a startup raises money from banks or investors.

WHAT YOU GET	HOW TO APPLY
- Seed assistance up to ₹30 lakh via empanelled incubators 15% of funds raised, up to ₹15 lakh each time, four times (₹60 lakh total) ₹100 crore Startup Capital Fund, up to ₹50 crore routed through AIFs	- Register on the MP startup portal - Claim investment-linked assistance after each funding round
WHO CAN APPLY	DOCUMENTS
DPIIT-recognised startups based in Madhya Pradesh	☐ DPIIT recognition certificate ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed) ☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state ☐ Cap table / shareholding pattern ☐ Bank statements for the last 6–12 months

Official: invest.mp.gov.in/policy-notifications-sp-implementation-scheme Stacks with: FoF 2.0, CGSS State ranking 2026: Leader
Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (policy summaries, Mar 2025)

Maharashtra Startup, Entrepreneurship & Innovation Policy 2025

SUPPORT	₹500 cr Maha-Fund; ₹25 L pilot orders	TYPE	Grant, IP support, Govt buyer, Incubation
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

Approved 6 August 2025 to create 1.25 lakh entrepreneurs and 50,000 startups in five years. Every state department must set aside 0.5% of its budget for innovation, and startups get help with patents, certifications and exhibitions.

WHAT YOU GET

- Maha-Fund (₹500 crore) for 25,000 early-stage entrepreneurs
- Startup Week: pilot work orders up to ₹25 lakh with state departments
- Reimbursement for patents, quality certification and exhibitions
- Micro-incubators in ITIs and polytechnics; regional hubs; a 300-acre Innovation City

WHO CAN APPLY

- Startups and entrepreneurs based in Maharashtra

HOW TO APPLY

1. Register on the MSInS portal
2. Apply to the relevant programme or claim reimbursements

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction
- ☐ Invoices and payment receipts for costs you're claiming

Official: msins.in Stacks with: MH Startup Week, Maha-Fund State ranking 2026: Leader

Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (policy approval coverage)

Maharashtra Startup Week

SUPPORT	Work orders up to ₹25 lakh	TYPE	Govt buyer, Challenge / prize
STAGE	Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Any sector, Software & AI
EFFORT	Competitive — pitch or jury	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Startups pitch solutions to state departments; winners get a pilot work order worth up to ₹25 lakh — often a startup's first government customer.

WHAT YOU GET

- Pilot work order up to ₹25 lakh with a state department

WHO CAN APPLY

- Startups with a working product relevant to governance

HOW TO APPLY

1. Apply on the MSInS portal when the edition opens
2. Pitch to the jury of department heads

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction
- ☐ Proof of prototype or PoC — photos, video, test data

MAHARASHTRA · GOVT OF MAHARASHTRA

OPEN · ROLLING

Maha-Fund for early entrepreneurs

SUPPORT	₹500 cr corpus	TYPE	Grant, Incubation
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

Selects 25,000 early-stage entrepreneurs from a pool of 5 lakh youth in three stages, then supports them with mentoring, incubation and funding.

WHAT YOU GET

- Mentoring, incubation and early funding for selected entrepreneurs

WHO CAN APPLY

- Youth and early entrepreneurs in Maharashtra

HOW TO APPLY

1. Apply through MSInS channels when selection rounds open

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN
- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget

Official: msins.in Stacks with: MH Policy 2025 State ranking 2026: Leader Checked: Verified Sep 2026

Manipur

RANKING 2026: LEADER

MANIPUR · GOVT OF MANIPUR

CLOSED

Start-Up Manipur

SUPPORT	₹3 L idea · up to ₹30 L revenue stage	TYPE	Grant, Subsidy
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Main scheme ran 2018–2021 (activities to 2023); check for a new round

The CM's flagship startup scheme supported 10,296 entrepreneurs with ₹79 crore between 2017 and 2023, with idea-stage grants and larger subsidies for revenue-stage startups.

WHAT YOU GET

- Idea stage: ₹3 lakh
- Revenue/Stand-up stage: up to ₹30 lakh

WHO CAN APPLY

- Manipur residents with a business idea or running startup

HOW TO APPLY

1. Check the Startup Manipur portal for new rounds

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN
- ☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state
- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget

Official: startupmanipur.in Stacks with: Mudra, PMEGP State ranking 2026: Leader Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (CM dashboard)

PRIME Meghalaya Funding

SUPPORT	Grants to ₹35 L · 0% loans to ₹75 L	TYPE	Grant, Loan
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Any sector, Agri & food
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Promotion and Incubation of Market-driven Enterprises: grants for early ideas and high-impact innovations, and interest-free loans for startups with traction.

WHAT YOU GET

- Kick Start Grant up to ₹10 lakh
- InnoVenture Grant up to ₹35 lakh for high-impact innovations
- Scale-up Innovation Loan up to ₹75 lakh at zero interest
- Small Support Grant up to ₹3 lakh for operating micro/small units

WHO CAN APPLY

- Entrepreneurs from Meghalaya

HOW TO APPLY

1. Apply on the PRIME website when windows open

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN
- ☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state
- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction

Official: www.primemeghalaya.com

Stacks with: SIPP

State ranking 2026: Leader

Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (PRIME funding page)

Mizoram

Mizoram Startup Mission & Bana Kaih

SUPPORT	Grants, venture funding, credit linkage	TYPE	Grant, Loan
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No

The Mizoram Entrepreneurship & Startup Policy (2019) and Startup Mission support incubation, while the Bana Kaih (Handholding) scheme offers grants, venture funding and credit linkage to selected 'Progress Partners'.

WHAT YOU GET

- Handholding grants, loans and credit linkage under Bana Kaih
- Incubation via the Mizoram Startup Mission

WHO CAN APPLY

- Entrepreneurs in Mizoram

HOW TO APPLY

1. Register as a Progress Partner for Bana Kaih
2. Connect with the Mizoram Startup Mission

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN
- ☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state
- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget

Nagaland

RANKING 2026: LEADER

NAGALAND · DEPT OF INDUSTRIES & COMMERCE, GOVT OF NAGALAND

OPEN · ROLLING

Nagaland Startup Policy 2019

SUPPORT	Reimbursements up to ₹5-10 L each	TYPE	Subsidy, IP support, Tax relief
STAGE	Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Reimbursement-led support for Nagaland startups covering GST, power, digital equipment, connectivity, patents and marketing.

WHAT YOU GET

- SGST reimbursement up to ₹5 lakh/year for 3 years
- 50% power subsidy up to ₹10 lakh/year for 5 years
- 50% of digital hardware/software costs up to ₹5 lakh
- Patents: ₹2 lakh (domestic), ₹5 lakh (international); 50% marketing up to ₹5 lakh

WHO CAN APPLY

- Startups registered in Nagaland

HOW TO APPLY

1. Register on Startup Nagaland
2. Submit reimbursement claims

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state
- ☐ Invoices and payment receipts for costs you're claiming

Official: www.startupnagaland.in Stacks with: SIPP State ranking 2026: Leader Checked: Per policy coverage

Odisha

RANKING 2026: ASPIRING LEADER

ODISHA · MSME DEPT, GOVT OF ODISHA

OPEN · ROLLING

Startup Odisha Incentives

SUPPORT	₹20k/month + up to ₹15 L product & marketing	TYPE	Stipend, Grant
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Recognised Odisha startups get a monthly allowance, funds for product development and marketing, need-based assistance for materials, and subsidised space at state incubators such as O-Hub.

WHAT YOU GET

- Monthly allowance ₹20,000 (₹22,000 for women and disadvantaged founders) for up to a year
- Product development & marketing assistance up to ₹15 lakh (₹16 lakh for reserved categories)
- Patent cost reimbursement; state procurement preference

HOW TO APPLY

1. Register and get recognised on the Startup Odisha portal
2. Apply for each incentive with a development plan

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)

WHO CAN APPLY

- Startups recognised by Startup Odisha

- ☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction
- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget

Official: startupodisha.gov.in

Stacks with: SIPP, NIDHI-SSP

State ranking 2026: Aspiring Leader

Checked: Per Startup Odisha guidance (2026)

Puducherry

RANKING 2026: EMERGING

PUDUCHERRY · INDUSTRIES & COMMERCE DEPT, PUDUCHERRY

OPEN · ROLLING

Puducherry Startup Policy 2019

SUPPORT	₹3 L grant + ₹10k/month per person	TYPE	Grant, Stipend
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Incubator-recommended grants and monthly allowances for founders, backed by a ₹10 crore Puducherry Startup Fund for incubators.

WHAT YOU GET

- Grant up to ₹3 lakh for incubator-recommended projects
- ₹10,000/month per person for up to 5 people (₹15,000 for women, SC/ST, PH, transgender founders)
- Free ERP, cloud, lab and library access

WHO CAN APPLY

- Startups incubated in Puducherry

HOW TO APPLY

1. Get recommended by a Puducherry incubator
2. Apply to the Industries Department

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Letter from your incubator confirming incubation
- ☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state

Official: industry.py.gov.in/startup-policy-2019

Stacks with: SIPP

State ranking 2026: Emerging

Checked: Per 2019 policy

Punjab

RANKING 2026: TOP PERFORMER

PUNJAB · DEPT OF INDUSTRIES & COMMERCE, GOVT OF PUNJAB

OPEN · ROLLING

Punjab Startup & Industrial Policy 2026

SUPPORT	Seed grant ₹5 lakh	TYPE	Grant
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Punjab raised its startup seed grant from ₹3 lakh to ₹5 lakh under the 2026 policy (announced 9 June 2026); 31 startups received ₹1.07 crore in the latest round.

WHAT YOU GET

- Seed grant up to ₹5 lakh

HOW TO APPLY

1. Register with Startup Punjab
2. Apply for the seed grant when rounds open

- Other incentives for incubation and scale-up under the policy

WHO CAN APPLY

- Startups registered in Punjab

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction

Official: investpunjab.gov.in

Stacks with: SIPP

State ranking 2026: Top Performer

Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (Jun 2026 coverage)

Rajasthan

RANKING 2026: LEADER

RAJASTHAN · DEPT OF IT & COMMUNICATION, GOVT OF RAJASTHAN

OPEN · ROLLING

iStart Rajasthan

SUPPORT	Seed up to ₹10 L; ₹10-25k/month allowance	TYPE	Grant, Stipend, Equity
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

Rajasthan's startup platform: a QRate rating unlocks sustenance allowances, idea and seed grants, marketing support and investment from the ₹500 crore Bhamashah Startup Promotion Fund.

WHAT YOU GET

- Sustenance allowance ₹25,000/month (urban) or ₹10,000/month (rural)
- Idea-stage funding up to ₹2.5 lakh; seed funding up to ₹10 lakh
- Marketing grants up to ₹10 lakh
- Equity via the Bhamashah Startup Promotion Fund

WHO CAN APPLY

- Rajasthan-based startups up to 7 years old (10 for biotech), turnover up to ₹25 crore
- A valid QRate rating for funding above ₹5 lakh

HOW TO APPLY

1. Create a Rajasthan SSO ID and register on iStart
2. Get a QRate rating
3. Apply for the relevant incentive

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction
- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN

Official: istart.rajasthan.gov.in

Stacks with: SIPP, NIDHI-SSP

State ranking 2026: Leader

Checked: Amounts per secondary sources; confirm on iStart

Sikkim Skilled Youth Startup Scheme

SUPPORT	25–35% subsidy on projects up to ₹20 L	TYPE	Subsidy, Loan
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

Helps unemployed local youth start businesses with a capital subsidy on bank-financed projects.

WHAT YOU GET

- 25% subsidy (manufacturing/services); 35% for certain non-manufacturing projects
- Projects up to ₹20 lakh

WHO CAN APPLY

- Sikkim Subject certificate holders aged 15–40, unemployed, Class 5 pass; one per family

HOW TO APPLY

1. Apply at the District Industries Centre (Gangtok or Jorethang)

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Founders' KYC — Aadhaar and PAN
- ☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state
- ☐ Detailed project report (DPR) with cost estimates
- ☐ Educational certificates of the founders

Official: industries.sikkim.gov.in

Stacks with: PMEGP, Mudra

State ranking 2026: Aspiring Leader

Checked: Active as of 2025

Tamil Nadu

TANSEED

SUPPORT	₹10 L (₹15 L for green, rural, women-led)	TYPE	Equity, Incubation
STAGE	Early revenue	SECTOR	Any sector, Energy & climate
EFFORT	Competitive — pitch or jury	DPIIT NEEDED	Yes

8.0 applications closed 30 Jan 2026; watch for 9.0

Tamil Nadu's seed programme: an equity-linked grant plus a year-long accelerator. StartupTN takes a small support stake.

WHAT YOU GET

- ₹10 lakh seed support; ₹15 lakh for green-tech, rural-impact and women-led startups
- One-year accelerator programme

WHO CAN APPLY

- StartupTN-registered, DPIIT-recognised startups with a prototype or traction
- About 3% support stake to StartupTN

HOW TO APPLY

1. Register on StartupTN
2. Apply when the next TANSEED edition opens
3. Pitch rounds, then onboarding to the accelerator

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ DPIIT recognition certificate
- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction
- ☐ Cap table / shareholding pattern

☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state

Official: startuptn.in

Stacks with: StartupTN, NIDHI-SSP

State ranking 2026: Top Performer

Checked: Verified Sep 2026

TAMIL NADU · MSME DEPT, GOVT OF TAMIL NADU

OPEN · ROLLING

Tamil Nadu Startup & Innovation Policy (StartupTN)

SUPPORT	Seed, investor matching, regional hubs	TYPE	Incubation, Equity, Mentoring & network
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

StartupTN is the state's nodal agency: TANSEED seed support, TANFUND investor-matching platform, regional startup hubs across districts, and pitch events. Tamil Nadu was a Top Performer in the 2026 state startup rankings.

WHAT YOU GET

- TANFUND platform connecting startups with investors
- Regional hubs and incubators outside Chennai
- Events, mentoring and market access

WHO CAN APPLY

- Startups registered in Tamil Nadu

HOW TO APPLY

1. Register your startup on the StartupTN portal
2. Apply to programmes as they open

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction

Official: startuptn.in

Stacks with: TANSEED, IVP

State ranking 2026: Top Performer

Checked: Ranking verified Jan 2026

TAMIL NADU · EDII-TAMIL NADU, MSME DEPT

CLOSED

Innovation Voucher Programme (EDII-TN)

SUPPORT	₹3 L (Voucher A) · ₹7 L (Voucher B)	TYPE	Grant
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Any sector, Manufacturing & hardware
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Last round closed 10 Dec 2025; runs in periodic rounds

Vouchers that pay for R&D collaboration with knowledge institutions (Voucher A) and for taking a product to market (Voucher B).

WHAT YOU GET

- Voucher A: ₹3 lakh for research collaboration
- Voucher B: ₹7 lakh for market entry

WHO CAN APPLY

- Tamil Nadu startups and MSMEs at idea or product stage

HOW TO APPLY

1. Apply on the EDII-TN portal when the next round opens

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget
- ☐ Udyam (MSME) registration certificate

Telangana

RANKING 2026: LEADER

TELANGANA · ITE&C DEPT, GOVT OF TELANGANA

OPEN · ROLLING

Telangana Startup Incentives (Innovation Policy)

SUPPORT	SGST refunds, patent costs, hiring support	TYPE	Subsidy, Tax relief, IP support
STAGE	Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Any sector, Software & AI
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Reimbursements for Telangana startups: state GST refunds, patent costs, international marketing and hiring local staff, plus a performance grant for fast-growing startups.

WHAT YOU GET

- 100% SGST reimbursement for 3 years (on turnover up to ₹1 crore a year)
- Patent costs: up to ₹2 lakh (Indian) and ₹10 lakh (foreign)
- 30% of international trade-show costs, up to ₹5 lakh
- ₹10,000 per Telangana-domiciled employee hired in the first year
- Performance grant: 5% of turnover (up to ₹10 lakh) for 15% year-on-year growth

WHO CAN APPLY

- Startups registered in Telangana, usually within 3–5 years of incorporation
- Some incentives need endorsement from a state-supported incubator

HOW TO APPLY

1. Register on the Startup Telangana portal
2. File reimbursement claims with receipts

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state
- ☐ Invoices and payment receipts for costs you're claiming
- ☐ Financial statements / ITRs for the last 2–3 years (if any)
- ☐ Company PAN and GST registration (if registered)

Official: startup.telangana.gov.in/funding-incentives Stacks with: T-Hub, SIPP State ranking 2026: Leader

Checked: Per Startup Telangana incentives page; check current validity of each G.O.

TELANGANA · GOVT OF TELANGANA

OPEN · ROLLING

T-Hub, T-Works & T-Fund

SUPPORT	Incubation, prototyping labs, early equity	TYPE	Incubation, Equity, Labs & infra
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue, Growth / scaling	SECTOR	Any sector, Manufacturing & hardware, Software & AI
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

T-Hub is one of India's largest startup incubators; T-Works is a large public hardware prototyping centre; T-Fund makes early-stage equity investments; T-Spark gives grants and go-to-market support to early startups.

WHAT YOU GET

- Incubation and corporate innovation programmes (T-Hub)

HOW TO APPLY

1. Apply to T-Hub programmes or book T-Works facilities online

- Low-cost access to machines for hardware prototyping (T-Works)
 - Early-stage equity (T-Fund) and grants via T-Spark
- WHO CAN APPLY
- Varies by programme; T-Works is open to students and makers

Official: startup.telangana.gov.in Stacks with: TG Incentives, TGIC State ranking 2026: Leader Checked: Standing institutions

TELANGANA · TELANGANA INNOVATION CELL

OPENS IN ROUNDS

Telangana Innovation Cell student & grassroots programmes

SUPPORT	Recognition, seed & prototype support	TYPE	Challenge / prize, Grant
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue	SECTOR	Any sector, Agri & food
EFFORT	Simple — online form	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

The School Innovation Challenge (with UNICEF) for school students, Intinta Innovator for grassroots innovators, and TSIRI grants for rural-impact innovation.

WHAT YOU GET

- School and grassroots innovation challenges
- Seed, prototype and pilot support for rural-impact innovators (TSIRI)

WHO CAN APPLY

- School students, grassroots innovators and early rural-impact startups in Telangana

HOW TO APPLY

1. Register for the current challenge on the TGIC site

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Student ID or bonafide certificate from your institution
- ☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget

Official: teamtsic.telangana.gov.in Stacks with: T-Hub State ranking 2026: Leader Checked: Standing programmes

Tripura

RANKING 2026: ASPIRING LEADER

TRIPURA · DEPT OF IT, GOVT OF TRIPURA

OPEN · ROLLING

Tripura Start-Up Policy 2024

SUPPORT	₹2 L seed + ₹20k/month + ₹10 L prototype	TYPE	Grant, Stipend, IP support, Govt buyer
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Any sector, Agri & food
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Launched 24 January 2025 with a ₹50 crore VC fund (managed by SIDBI Venture Capital) and a ₹25 crore infrastructure fund.

WHAT YOU GET

- Seed ₹2 lakh; operational support ₹20,000/month for up to a year
- Prototype assistance up to ₹10 lakh; marketing up to ₹5 lakh
- Patents: ₹2 lakh (Indian), up to ₹10 lakh (foreign)

HOW TO APPLY

1. Register on the Start-Up Tripura portal
2. Apply for each incentive

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)

- Up to 15% price preference in state tenders; extra support for women and differently-abled founders

WHO CAN APPLY

- Startups registered in Tripura

☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state

☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction

☐ Project proposal with milestones and budget

Official: startup.tripura.gov.in

Stacks with: SIPP

State ranking 2026: Aspiring Leader

Checked: Verified Sep 2026 (launch coverage)

Uttar Pradesh

RANKING 2026: TOP PERFORMER

UTTAR PRADESH · DEPT OF IT & ELECTRONICS, GOVT OF UP (STARTINUP)

OPEN · ROLLING

UP Startup Policy 2020 (amended 2022)

SUPPORT	₹17,500/month + ₹5 L prototype + ₹7.5 L seed	TYPE	Grant, Stipend, IP support
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

Incubator-routed support for Uttar Pradesh startups, with 50% extra for women, transgender and differently-abled co-founders and for startups in Purvanchal and Bundelkhand.

WHAT YOU GET

- Sustenance allowance ₹17,500/month for a year
- Prototype grant up to ₹5 lakh
- Seed capital / marketing assistance up to ₹7.5 lakh
- Patent reimbursement: ₹2 lakh (Indian), ₹10 lakh (international)
- Event participation support

WHO CAN APPLY

- UP-based startups incubated at a state-supported incubator

HOW TO APPLY

1. Register on the StartinUP portal
2. Apply through your incubator

DOCUMENTS

☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)

☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state

☐ Letter from your incubator confirming incubation

☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction

Official: startinup.up.gov.in

Stacks with: SIPP, PRAYAS

State ranking 2026: Top Performer

Checked: Per 2022 amendment; policy valid 5 years from notification — check for a successor

Uttarakhand

RANKING 2026: LEADER

UTTARAKHAND · DEPT OF INDUSTRIES, GOVT OF UTTARAKHAND

OPEN · ROLLING

Uttarakhand Startup Policy 2023

SUPPORT	₹20k/month + ₹5 L product & marketing	TYPE	Stipend, Grant, Tax relief
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Any sector
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No

Monthly allowances, product and marketing support and tax refunds for recognised Uttarakhand startups, with higher amounts for focus sectors, women and SC/ST founders and remote districts.

WHAT YOU GET

- Sustenance allowance ₹20,000/month for a year (higher for priority categories)
- Product development & marketing up to ₹5 lakh (₹7.5 lakh for priority categories)
- Need-based assistance up to ₹5 lakh
- SGST reimbursement up to ₹5 lakh a year for 3 years; stamp-duty refunds

WHO CAN APPLY

- Uttarakhand startups with equity funding, a government grant, or monthly revenue in the prescribed range

HOW TO APPLY

1. Register on the Startup Uttarakhand portal
2. Apply for recognition and incentives

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)
- ☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction
- ☐ Financial statements / ITRs for the last 2–3 years (if any)

Official: startuputtarakhand.uk.gov.in

Stacks with: SIPP

State ranking 2026: Leader

Checked: Per policy summaries

West Bengal

WEST BENGAL · GOVT OF WEST BENGAL

ANNOUNCED — NOT YET OPEN

Startup Bengal & new state startup policy

SUPPORT	₹40 cr incubation fund · ₹60 cr VC fund (announced)	TYPE	Grant, Equity
STAGE	Idea / pre-revenue, Early revenue	SECTOR	Any sector, Deep tech
EFFORT	Moderate — proposal and review	DPIIT NEEDED	No · Student-friendly

New policy announced in Budget 2026-27

The existing Startup Bengal framework offers kick-starter funds and venture-capital access. The 2026-27 state budget announced a new startup policy with a ₹40 crore incubation fund and a ₹60 crore VC fund.

WHAT YOU GET

- Existing: kick-starter funds, patent reimbursement, priority access to the WB MSME VC fund
- Announced: ₹40 crore incubation fund (ideation to early stage) and ₹60 crore VC fund

WHO CAN APPLY

- Startups registered with the state

HOW TO APPLY

1. Register on the Startup Bengal portal
2. Watch for the new policy notification

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Certificate of incorporation (company / LLP / partnership deed)

- ☐ Proof that the startup is registered or operating in the state
- ☐ Pitch deck — problem, solution, market, team, traction

Official: www.startupbengal.in

Stacks with: SIPP

Checked: Budget announcement verified; policy notification awaited

Lakshadweep

RANKING 2026: EMERGING

No dedicated startup scheme listed. Founders can use every central scheme in Part I.

The acronyms, decoded

AIF

Alternative Investment Fund — a SEBI-registered pooled fund, such as a venture capital fund.

AIFs

Alternative Investment Funds — SEBI-registered pooled funds, such as venture capital funds.

AIM

Atal Innovation Mission, run by NITI Aayog.

angel tax

The old tax on share premium above fair value, abolished from AY 2025-26.

ANRF

Anusandhan National Research Foundation — manages the RDI Fund.

BIRAC

Biotechnology Industry Research Assistance Council — DBT's funding arm for biotech startups.

CGTMSE

Credit Guarantee Fund Trust for Micro and Small Enterprises — guarantees collateral-free loans to small firms.

convertible debentures

Debt that can later convert into equity shares.

CPSE

Central public sector enterprise — a company owned by the central government.

DBT

Department of Biotechnology.

DIC

District Industries Centre — the district office for industry schemes.

DPIIT

Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade — the central department that recognises startups and runs Startup India.

DPR

Detailed project report — a costed plan banks and agencies use to appraise a project.

DST

Department of Science and Technology.

EDA

Electronic design automation — software used to design chips.

EIR

Entrepreneur in Residence — a stipend to work full time on a startup idea.

EMD

Earnest money deposit — a security deposit normally required to bid in tenders.

GeM

Government e-Marketplace — the online portal through which government departments buy.

IIC

Institution's Innovation Council — the innovation cell in a college.

IMB

Inter-Ministerial Board — the panel that certifies startups for the income-tax holiday.

IPR

Intellectual property rights — patents, trademarks, designs, copyright.

KSUM

Kerala Startup Mission — Kerala's startup agency.

KVIC

Khadi and Village Industries Commission — implements PMEGP.

MeitY

Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology.

MSInS

Maharashtra State Innovation Society — Maharashtra's startup agency.

MSME

Micro, small and medium enterprise.

MVP

Minimum viable product — the simplest version customers can use.

NABARD

National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development.

NBFC

Non-banking financial company — an RBI-regulated lender that isn't a bank.

NCGTC

National Credit Guarantee Trustee Company — runs government credit guarantee schemes such as CGSS.

NIDHI

National Initiative for Developing and Harnessing Innovations — DST's umbrella programme for startup support.

PoC

Proof of concept — evidence that your core idea works.

QRate

iStart Rajasthan's startup rating, needed for larger state incentives.

R-ABI

RKVY Agribusiness Incubator — agri incubators that run the RKVY startup grants.

SEBI

Securities and Exchange Board of India — the markets regulator that registers VC funds.

SGST

State Goods and Services Tax — the state's share of GST, which some states refund to startups.

SIDBI

Small Industries Development Bank of India — the lead development bank for MSMEs and the manager of several startup funds.

SLFM

Second Level Fund Manager — an agency (like TDB or BIRAC) that deploys RDI Fund money to companies.

SPOC

Single point of contact — the coordinator at your institution.

sustenance allowance

A monthly stipend some states pay founders so they can work on their startup full time.

TBI

Technology Business Incubator — an incubator, usually at an academic institution, supported by DST.

TDB

Technology Development Board — a DST body that lends to and invests in technology companies.

TReDS

Trade Receivables Discounting System — platforms where small firms sell invoices for early payment.

TRL

Technology Readiness Level — a 1–9 scale; TRL 4 means a technology validated in the lab.

Udyam

The official MSME registration, done online with Aadhaar and PAN.

venture debt

Loans to startups, usually alongside equity rounds, from specialised lenders.

Method: each entry was checked in September 2026 against the official portal, PIB releases, Parliament replies or reputable coverage; the "Checked" line on each entry notes the source type. Where only a secondary source was available, the entry says so. Nothing here is legal or financial advice — confirm with the implementing agency or your CA.